

Daemonologie

In Form of a Dialogue,
Divided into three Books.

A modern-spelling edition

By James R^X

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THE PREFACE.

To the Reader.

The fearful abounding at this time in this country, of these detestable slaves of the Devil, the Witches or enchanter, has moved me (beloved reader) to dispatch in post, this following treatise of mine, not in any wise (as I protest) to serve for a show of my learning and ingenuity, but only (moved of conscience) to press thereby, so far as I can, to resolve the doubting hearts of many; both that such assaults of Satan are most certainly practiced, and that the instruments thereof, merits most severely to be punished: against the damnable opinions of two principally in our age, whereof the one called SCOT an Englishman, is not ashamed in public print to deny, that there can be such a thing as Witchcraft: and so maintains the old error of the Sadducees, in denying of spirits. The other called WIERUS, a German Physician, sets out a public apology for all these crafts-folk, whereby, procuring for their impunity, he plainly betrays himself to have been one of that profession. And for to make this treatise the more pleasant and facile, I have put it in form of a Dialogue, which I have divided into three books: The first speaking of Magic in general, and Necromancy in special. The second of Sorcery and Witchcraft: and the third, contains a discourse of all these kinds of spirits, and Spectres that appears and troubles persons: together with a conclusion of the whole work. My intention in this labour, is only to prove two things, as I have already said: the one, that such devilish arts have been and are. The other, what exact trial and severe punishment they merit: and therefore reason I, what kind of things are possible to be performed in these arts, and by what natural causes they may be, not that I touch every particular thing of the Devil's power, for that were infinite: but only, to speak scholastically, (since this can not be spoken in our language) I reason upon *genus* leaving species, and *differentia* to be comprehended therein. As for example, speaking of the power of Magicians, in the first book and sixth Chapter: I say, that they can suddenly cause be brought unto them, all kinds of dainty dishes, by their familiar spirit: Since as a thief he delights to steal, and as a spirit, he can subtly and suddenly enough transport the same. Now under this *genus* may be comprehended all particulars, depending thereupon; Such as the bringing Wine out of a Wall, (as we have heard often to have been practised) and such others; which particulars, are sufficiently proved by the reasons of the general. And such like in the second book of Witchcraft in special, and fifth Chap. I say and prove by diverse arguments, that Witches can, by the power of their Master, cure or cast on diseases: Now by these same reasons, that proves their power by the Devil of diseases in generally is as well proved their power in special: as of weakening the nature of some men, to make them unable for women: and making it to abound in others, more then the ordinary course of nature would permit. And such like in all other particular sickness; But one thing I will pray you to observe in all these places, where I reason upon the devil's power, which is the different ends and scopes, that God as

the first cause, and the Devil as his instrument and second cause shoots at in all these actions of the Devil, (as God's hangman:) For where the devil's intention in them is ever to perish, either the soul or the body, or both of them, that he is so permitted to deal with: God by the contrary, draws ever out of that evil glory to himself, either by the wreck of the wicked in his justice, or by the trial of the patient, and amendment of the faithful, being wakened up with that rod of correction. Having thus declared unto you then, my full intention in this Treatise, you will easily excuse, I doubt not, as well my omitting, to declare the whole particular rites and secrets of these unlawful arts: as also their infinite and wonderful practices, as being neither of them pertinent to my purpose: the reason whereof, is given in the hinder end of the first Chapter of the third book: and who likes to be curious in these things, he may read, if he will here of their practices, BODINUS *Demonomania*, collected with greater diligence, then written with judgment, together with their confessions, that have been at this time apprehended. If he would know what has been the opinion of the Ancients, concerning their power: he shall see it well described by HYPERIUS, and HEMMINGIUS, two late German writers: Besides innumerable other neoteric Theologians, that writes largely upon that subject: And if he would know what are the particular rites, & curiosities of these black arts (which is both unnecessary and perilous,) he will find it in the fourth book of CORNELIUS Agrippa, and in WIERUS, of whom I spoke. And so wishing my pains in this Treatise (beloved Reader) to be effectual, in arming all them that reads the same, against these above mentioned errors, and recommending my good will to your friendly acceptance, I bid you heartily fare-well.

JAMES Rx.

FIRST BOOK.

ARGUMENT.

The introduction of the whole. The description of Magic in special.

CHAPTER I.

ARGUMENT.

Proven by the Scripture, that these unlawful arts in genere, have been and may be put in practice.

PHILOMATHES and EPISTEMON reason the matter.

Philomathes. I am surely very glad to have met with you this day, for I am of opinion, that you can better resolve me of some thing, whereof I stand in great doubt, than any other with whom I could have met.

Epi. In what I can, that you like to ask at me, I will willingly and freely tell my opinion, and if I prove it not sufficiently, I am heartily content that a better reason carry it away then.

Phi. What think you of these strange news, which now only furnishes purpose to all men at their meeting: I mean of these Witches?

Epi. Surely they are wonderful: And I think so clear and plain confessions in that purpose, have never fallen out in any age or country.

Phi. No question if they be true, but thereof the Doctors doubts.

Epi. What part of it doubt you of?

Phi. Even of all, for ought I can yet perceive: and namely, that there is such a thing as Witchcraft or Witches, and I would pray you to resolve me thereof if you may: for I have reasoned with sundry in that matter, and yet could never be satisfied therein.

Epi. I shall with good will do the best I can: But I think it the more difficult, since you deny the thing itself in general: for as it is said in the logic schools, *Contra negantem principia non est disputandum*. Always for that part, that witchcraft, and Witches have been, and are, the former part is clearly proved by the Scriptures, and the last by daily experience and confessions.

Phi. I know you will allege me *Saul's Pythoness*: but that as appears will not make much for you.

Epi. Not only that place, but divers others: But I marvel why that should not make much for me?

Phi. The reasons are these, first you may consider, that *Saul* being troubled in spirit, (M1) and having fasted long before, as the text testifies, and being come to a woman that was reported to have such knowledge, and that to inquire so important news, he having so guilty a conscience for his heinous offences, and specially, for that same unlawful curiosity, and horrible defection: and then the woman crying out upon the sudden in great admiration, for the uncouth sight that she alleged to have seen, discovering him to be the King, though disguised, and denied by him before: it was no wonder I say, that his senses being thus distracted, he could not perceive her feigning of her voice, he being himself in an other chamber, and seeing nothing. Next what could be, or was raised? The spirit of *Samuel*? Profane and against all Theology: the Devil in his likeness? as imperceptible, that either God would permit him to come in the shape of his Saints (for then could never the Prophets in those days have been sure, what Spirit spoke to them in their visions) or then that he could fore-tell what was to come there after; for Prophecy proceeds only of GOD: and the Devil has no knowledge of things to come.

Epi. Yet if you will mark the words of the text, you will find clearly, that *Saul* saw that apparition: for giving you that *Saul* was in an other Chamber, at the making of the circles and conjurations, necessary for that purpose (as none of that craft will permit any others to behold at that time) yet it is evident by the text, that how soon that once that unclean spirit was fully risen, she called in upon *Saul*. For it is said in the text, that *Saul knew him to be Samuel*, which could not have been, by the hearing tell only of an old man with an mantle, since there was many more old men dead in *Israel* than *Samuel*: And the common garb of that whole Country was mantles. As to the next, that it was not the spirit of *Samuel*, I grant: In the proving whereof you need not to insist, since all Christians of whatsoever Religion agrees upon that: and none but either mere ignorant folk, or Necromancers or Witches doubts thereof. And that the Devil is permitted at sometimes to put himself in the likeness of the Saints, it is plain in the Scriptures, where it is said, that *Satan can trans-form himself into an Angel of light*. (M2) Neither could that bring any inconvenient with the visions of the Prophets, since it is most certain, that God will not permit him so to deceive his own: but only such, as first willfully deceives them-selves, by running unto him, whom God then suffers to fall in their own snares, and justly permits them to be eluded with great efficacy of deceit, because they would not believe the truth (as *Paul* saith). And as to the devil's foretelling of things to come, it is true that he knows not all things future, but yet that he knows part, the Tragic event of this history declares it, (which the wit of woman could never have fore-spoken) not that he has any prescience, which is only proper to God: or yet knows any thing by looking upon God, as in a mirror (as the good Angels do) he being for ever debarred from the favorable presence & countenance of his creator, but only by one of these two means, either as being worldly wise, and taught by an continual experience, ever since the creation, judges by likelihood of things to come, according to the like that has passed before, and the natural causes, in respect of the vicissitude of all things worldly: Or

else by God's employing of him in a turn, and so foreseen thereof: as appears to have been in this, whereof we find the very like in *Micah* prophetic discourse to King *Ahab*. (M3) But to prove this my first proposition, that there can be such a thing as witchcraft, and witches, there are many more places in the Scriptures then this (as I said before). As first in the law of God, it is plainly prohibited: (M4) But certain it is, that the Law of God speaks nothing in vain, nether does it lay curses, or enjoin punishments upon shadows, condemning that to be il, which is not in essence or being as we call it. Secondly it is plain, where wicked *Pharaohs* wise-men imitated one number of *Moses* miracles, (M5) to harden the tyrants heart there by. Thirdly, said not *Samuel* to *Saul*, (M6) that *disobedience is as the sin of Witchcraft*? To compare to a thing that were not, it were too too absurd. Fourthly, was not *Simon Magus*, a man of that craft? (M7) And fifthly, what was she that had the spirit of *Python*? (M8) beside innumerable other places that were irksome to recite.

CHAPTER II.

ARGUMENT.

What kind of sin the practitioners of these unlawful arts commits. The division of these arts. And what are the means that allures any to practice them.

Philomathes. But I think it very strange, that God should permit any man-kind (since they bear his own Image) to fall in so gross and filthy a defection.

Epi. Although man in his Creation was (M9) made to the Image of the Creator, yet through his fall having once lost it, it is but restored again in a part by grace only to the elect: So all the rest falling away from God, are given over in the hands of the Devil that enemy, to bear his Image: and being once so given over, the greatest and the gross impiety, is the pleasant, and most delightful unto them.

Phi. But may it not suffice him to have indirectly the rule, and procure the perdition of so many souls by alluring them to vices, and to the following of their own appetites, suppose he abuse not so many simply souls, in making them directly acknowledge him for their master.

Epi. No surely, for he uses every man, whom of he has the rule, according to their complexion and knowledge: And so whom he finds most simply, he most plainly discovers himself unto them. For he being the enemy of mans Salvation, uses all the means he can to entrap them so farr in his snares, as it may be unable to them thereafter (suppose they would) to rid themselves out of the same.

Phi. Then this sin is a sin against the holy Ghost.

Epi. It is in some, but not in all.

Phi. How that? Are not all these that runs directly to the Devil in one Category.

Epi. God forbid, for the sin against the holy Ghost has two branches: The one a falling back from the whole service of GOD, and a refusal of all his precepts. The other is the doing of the first with knowledge, knowing that they do wrong against their own

conscience, and the testimony of (M10) the holy Spirit, having once had a taste of the sweetness of God's mercies. Now in the first of these two, all sorts of Necromancers, Enchanters or Witches, are comprehended: but in the last, none but such as errs with this knowledge that I have spoken of.

Phi. Then it appears that there are more sorts than one, that are directly professors of his service: and if so be, I pray you tell me how many, and what are they?

Epi. There are principally two sorts, to which all the parts of that unhappy art are reduced; whereof the one is called *Magic* or *Necromancy*, the other *Sorcery* or *Witchcraft*.

Phi. What I pray you? and how many are the means, whereby the Devil allures persons in any of these snares?

Epi. Even by these three passions that are within ourselves: Curiosity in great ingenuity: thirst of revenge, for some wrongs deeply apprehended: or greedy appetite of gear, caused through great poverty. As to the first of these, Curiosity, it is only the enticement of *Magicians*, or *Necromancers*: and the other two are the tempters of the *Sorcerers*, or *Witches*, for that old and crafty Serpent, being a spirit, he easily spies our affections, and so conforms himself thereto, to deceive us to our wreck.

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

The significations and Etymologies of the words of Magic and Necromancy. The difference between Necromancy and Witchcraft: What are the entrances, and beginnings, that brings any to the knowledge thereof.

Philomathes. I Would gladly first hear, what thing is it that you call *Magic* or *Necromancy*.

Epi. This word *Magic* in the *Persian* tongue, imports as much as to be one contemplator or Interpreter of Divine and heavenly sciences: which being first used amongst the *Chaldeans*, through their ignorance of the true divinity, was esteemed and reputed amongst them, as a principal virtue: And therefore, was named unjustly with an honorable style, which name the *Greeks* imitated, generally importing all these kinds of unlawful arts.

And this word *Necromancy* is a Greek word, compounded of Νεκρων & μαντεια, which is to say, the Prophecy by the dead. This last name is given, to this black and unlawful science by the figure *Synecdoche*, because it is a principal part of that art, to serve themselves with dead carcasses in their divinations.

Phi. What difference is there between this art, and Witchcraft.

Epi. Surely, the difference vulgar put between them, is very merry, and in a manner true; for they say, that the Witches are servants only, and slaves to the Devil; but the Necromancers are his masters and commanders.

Phi. How can that be true, that any men being specially addicted to his service, can be his commanders?

Epi. Yes, they may be: but it is only *secundum quid*: For it is not by any power that they can have over him, but *ex pacto* only: whereby he obliges himself in some trifles to them, that he may on the other part obtain the fruition of their body and soul, which is the only thing he hunts for.

Phi. An very inequitable contract indeed: But I pray you discourse unto me, what is the effect and secrets of that art?

Epi. That is over large an field you give me: yet I shall do good-will, the most summarily that I can, to rune through the principal points thereof. As there are two sorts of folks, that may be enticed to this art, to wit, learned or unlearned: so is there two means, which are the first instigators up and feeders of their curiosity, thereby to make them to give themselves over to the same: Which two means, I call the Devils school, and his rudiments. The learned have their curiosity wakened vp; and fed by that which I call his school: this is the *Astrology* judicial. For divers men having attained to a great perfection in learning, and yet remaining overbore (alas) of the spirit of regeneration and fruits thereof: finding all natural things common, as well to the stupid pedants as unto them, they assay to vindicate unto them a greater name, by not only knowing the course of things heavenly, but likewise to cling to the knowledge of things to come thereby. Which, at the first face appearing lawful unto them, in respect the ground thereof seems to proceed of natural causes only: they are so allured thereby, that finding their practice to prove true in sundry things, they study to know the cause thereof: and so mounting from degree to degree, upon the slippery and uncertain scale of curiosity; they are at last enticed, that where lawful arts or sciences fails, to satisfy their restless minds, even to seek to that black and unlawful science of *Magic*. Where, finding at the first, that such divers forms of circles & conjurations rightly joined to it, will raise such divers forms of spirits, to resolve them of their doubts: and attributing the doing thereof, to the power inseparably tied, or inherent in the circles: and many words of God, confusedly wrapped in; they blindly glory of themselves, as if they had by their quickness of ingenuity, made a conquest of *Pluto's* dominion, and were become Emperors over the *Stygian* dwellings. Where, in the mean time (miserable wretches) they are become in very deed, bond-slaves to their mortal enemy: and their knowledge, for all that they presume thereof, is nothing increased, except in knowing evil, and the horrors of Hell for punishment thereof, as *Adams* was by the eating of the forbidden tree. (M11)

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

The Description of the Rudiments and School, which are the entrances to the art of Magic: And in special the differences between Astronomy and Astrology: Division of Astrology in divers parts.

Philomathes. But I pray you likewise forget not to tell what are the Devil's rudiments.

Epi. His rudiments, I call first in general, all that which is called vulgarly the virtue of word, herb, and stone: which is used by unlawful charms, without natural causes. As likewise all kind of practices, omens, or other like extraordinary actions, which cannot abide the true touch of natural reason.

Phi. I would have you to make that plainer, by some particular examples; for your proposition is very general.

Epi. I mean either by such kind of Charms as commonly daft wives uses, for healing of bewitched goods, for preserving them from evil eyes, by knitting rowan trees, or sundry kind of herbs, to the hair or tails of the goods: By curing the Worm, by stemming of blood, by healing of Horse-crooks, by turning of the riddle, or doing of such like innumerable things by words, without applying any thing, meet to the part offended, as Doctors do; Or else by staying married folks, to have naturally ado with other, (by knitting so many knots upon a point at the time of their marriage). And such-like things, which men uses to practice in their merriness: For from unlearned men (being naturally curious, and lacking the true knowledge of God) finds these practices to prove true, as sundry of them will do, by the power of the Devil for deceiving men, and not by any inherent virtue in these vain words and omens; and being desirous to winn a reputation to themselves in such-like turns, they either (if they be of the more shamefaced sort) seek to be learned by some that are experimented in that Art, (not knowing it to be evil at the first) or else being of the grosser sort, runs directly to the Devil for ambition or desire of gain, and plainly contracts with him thereupon.

Phi. But me thinks these means which you call the School and rudiments of the Devil, are things lawful, and have been approved for such in all times and ages: As in special, this science of *Astrology*, which is one of the special members of the *Mathematics*.

Epi. There are two things which the learned have observed from the beginning, in the science of the Heavenly Creatures, the Planets, Stars, and such like: The one is their course and ordinary motions, which for that cause is called *Astronomia*: Which word is a compound of νομος and αστερων that is to say, the law of the Stars: And this art indeed is one of the members of the *Mathematics*, and not only lawful, but most necessary and commendable. The other is called *Astrologia*, being compounded of αστερων and λογος which is to say, the word, and preaching of the stars: Which is divided in two parts: The first by knowing thereby the powers of simples, and sicknesses, the course of the seasons and the weather, being ruled by their influence; which part depending upon the former, although it be not of itself a part of *Mathematics*: yet it is not unlawful, being moderately used, suppose not so necessary and commendable as the former. The second part is to trust so much to their influences, as thereby to fore-tell what commonwealths shall flourish or decay: what persons shall be fortunate or unfortunate: what side shall winn in any battle: What man shall obtain victory at singular combat: What way, and of what age shall men die: What horse shall winn at racing; and diverse such like incredible things, wherein *Cardanus*, *Cornelius Agrippa*, and diverse others have more curiously then profitably written at large. Of this root last spoken of, springs innumerable branches; such as the

knowledge by the nativities; the *Chiromancy*, *Geomancy*, *Hydromancy*, *Arithmancy*, *Physiognomy*: and a thousand others: which were much practised, and holden in great reverence by the *Gentlefolk* of old. And this last part of *Astrology* whereof I have spoken, which is the root of their branches, was called by them *pars fortune*. This part now is utterly unlawful to be trusted in, or practiced amongst christians, as leaning to no ground of natural reason: and it is this part which I called before the devil's school.

Phi. But yet many of the learned are of the contrary opinion.

Epi. I grant, yet I could give my reasons to fortify and maintain my opinion, if to enter into this disputation it would not draw me quite off the ground of our discourse; besides the mis-spending of the whole dai thereupon: One word only I will answer to them, and that in the Scriptures (which must be an infallible ground to all true Christians) That in the Prophet *Jeremiah* (M12) it is plainly forbidden, to believe or hearken unto them that Prophecies and fore-speaks by the course of the Planets & Stars.

CHAPTER V.

ARGUMENT.

How farr the using of Charms is lawful or unlawful: The description of the forms of Circles and Conjurations. And what causes the Magicians themselves to weary thereof.

Philomathes. Well, You have said far enough in that argument. But how prove you now that these charms or unnatural practices are unlawful: For so, many honest & merry men and women have publicly practiced some of them, that I think if you would accuse them all of Witchcraft, you would affirm more than you will be believed in.

Epi. I see if you had taken good tent (to the nature of that word, whereby I named it,) you would not have been in this doubt, nor mistaken me, so farr as you have done: For although, as none can be scholars in a school, & not be subject to the master thereof: so none can study and put in practice (for study the alone, and knowledge, is more perilous than offensive; and it is the practice only that makes the greatness of the offence.) the circles and art of *Magic*, without committing an horrible defection from God: And yet as they that reads and learns their rudiments, are not the more subject to any schoolmaster, if it please not their parents to put them to the school thereafter; So they who ignorantly proves these practices, which I cal the devil's rudiments, unknowing them to be baits, cast out by him, for trapping such as God will permit to fall in his hands: This kind of folks I say, no doubt, are to be judged the best of, in respect they use no invocation nor help of him (by their knowledge at least) in these turns, and so have never entered themselves in Satan's service; Yet to speak truly for my own part (I speak but for myself) I desire not to make so near riding: For in my opinion our enemy is over crafty, and we over weak (except the greater grace of God) to assay such hazards, wherein he presses to trap us.

Phi. You have reason indeed; for as the common Proverb says: They that supp broth with the Devil, have need of long spoons. But now I pray you go forward in the describing of this art of *Magic*.

Epi. From they be come once unto this perfection in evil, in having any knowledge (whether learned or unlearned) of this black art: they then begin to be weary of the raising of their Master, by conjured circles; being both so difficult and perilous, and so comes plainly to a contract with him, wherein is especially contained forms and effects.

Phi. But I pray you or ever you go further, discourse me some-what of their circles and conjurations; And what should be the cause of their wearying thereof: For it should seem that that form should be less fearful yet, than the direct haunting and society, with that foul and unclean Spirit.

Epi. I think you take me to be a Witch myself, or at the least would gladly swear yourself apprentice to that craft: Always as I may, I shall shortly satisfy you, in that kind of conjurations, which are contained in such books, which I call the Devil's School: There are four principal parts; the persons of the conjurers; the action of the conjuration; the words and rites used to that effect; and the Spirits that are conjured. You must first remember to lay the ground, that I told you before: which is, that it is no power inherent in the circles, or in the holiness of the names of God blasphemously used: nor in whatsoever rites or ceremonies at that time used, that either can raise any infernal spirit, or yet limited him perforce within or without these circles. For it is he only, the father of all lies, who having first of all prescribed that form of doing, feigning himself to be commanded & restrained thereby, will be loath to pass the bounds of these injunctions; as well thereby to make them glory in the rule over him (as I said before:) As likewise to make himself so to be trusted in these little things, that he may have the better commodity thereafter, to deceive them in the end with a trick once for all; I mean the everlasting perdition of their soul and body. Then laying this ground, as I have said, these conjurations must have few or more in number of the persons conjurers (always passing the singular number) according to the quality of the circle, and form of apparition. Two principal things cannot well in that errand be wanted: holy water (whereby the Devil mocks the *Papists*) and some present of a living thing unto him. There are likewise certain seasons, days and hours, that they observe in this purpose: These things being all ready, and prepared, circles are made triangular, quadrangular, round, double or single, according to the form of apparition that they crave. But to speak of the diverse forms of the circles, of the innumerable characters and crosses that are within and without, and out-through the same, of the divers forms of apparitions, that that crafty spirit eludes them with, and or all such particulars in that action, I remit it to over-mani that have busied their heads in describing of the same; as being but curious, and altogether unprofitable. And this farr only I touch, that when the conjured Spirit appears, which will not be while after many circumstances, long prayers, and much muttering and murmuring of the conjurers; like a *Papist* priest, dispatching a hunting *Mass*: how son I say, he appears, if they have missed one iota of all their rites; or if any of their feet once slid over the circle through terror of his fearful apparition, he pays himself at that time in his own hand, of that due debt which they ought him; and other-wise would have delayed longer to have paid him: I mean he carries them with him body and soul. If this be not now a just cause to make them weary of these forms of conjuration, I leave it to you to judge upon;

considering the tediousness of the labour, the precise keeping of days and hours (as I have said), the terribleness of apparition, and the present peril that they stand in, in missing the least circumstance or omen, that they ought to observe: And on the other part, the Devil is glad to move them to a plain and square dealing with him as I said before.

CHAPTER VI.

ARGUMENT.

The Devil's contract with the Magicians: The division thereof in two parts: What is the difference between God's miracles and the Devils.

Philomathes. Indeed there is cause enough, but rather to leave him at all, then to rune more plainly to him, if they were wise he dealt with. But go forwards now I pray you to these turns, from they become once deacons in this craft.

Epi. From time that they once plainly begin to contract with him: The effect of their contract consists in two things; in forms and effects, as I began to tell already, were it not you interrupted me (for although the contract be mutual; I speak first of that part, wherein the Devil obliges himself to them) by forms, I mean in what shape or fashion he shall come unto them, when they call upon him. And by effects, I understand, in what special sorts of services he binds himself to be subject unto them. The quality of these forms and effects, is less or greater, according to the skill and art of the *Magician*. For as to the forms, to some of the baser sort of them he obliges himself to appear at their calling upon him, by such a proper name which he shows unto them, either in likeness of a dog, a Cate, an Ape, or such-like other beast; or else to answer by a voice only. The effects are to answer to such demands, as concerns curing of diseases, their own particular menagerie: or such other base things as they require of him.

But to the most curious sort, in the forms he will oblige himself, to enter in a dead body, and there out of to give such answers, of the event of battles, of matters concerning the estate of commonwealths, and such like other great questions: yes, to some he will be a continual attendant, in form of a Page: He will permit himself to be conjured, for the space of so many years, ether in a tablet or a ring, or such like thing, which they may easily carrie about with them: He gives them power to self such wars to others, whereof some will be dearer, and some better cheap; according to the lying or true speaking of the Spirit that is conjured therein. Not but that in very deed, all Devils must be liars; but so they abuse the simplicity of these wretches, that becomes their scholars, that they make them believe, that at the fall of *Lucifer*, some Spirits fell in the air, some in the fire, some in the water, some in the land: In which Elements they still remain. Whereupon they build, that such as fell in the fire, or in the air, are truer then they, who fell in the water or in the land, which is all but mere chatter, and forged by the author of all deceit. For they fell not be weight, as a solid substance, to stick in any one part: But the principal part of their fall, consisting in quality, by the falling from the grace of God wherein they were created, they continued still thereafter, and shall do while the latter dai, in wandering through the world, as God's

hang-men, to execute such turns as he employs them in. And when any of them are not occupied in that, return they must to their prison in hell (as it is plain in the miracle that CHRIST wrought at *Gennesaret*) (M13) therein at the latter day to be all enclosed for ever: and as they deceive their scholars in this, so do they, in imprinting in them the opinion that there are so many Princes, Dukes, and Kings amongst them, every one commanding fewer or more Legions, and impairing in divers arts, and quarters of the earth. For though that I will not deny that there be a form of filth amongst the Angels in Heaven, and consequently, was amongst them before their fall; yet, either that they enjoy the same since; or that God will permit us to know by damned Devils, such heavenly mysteries of his, which he would not reveal to us neither by Scripture nor Prophets, I think no Christian will once think it. But by the contrary of all such mysteries, as he has closed up with his seal of secrecy; it becomes us to be contented with an humble ignorance, they being things not necessary for our salvation. But to return to the purpose, as these forms, wherein Satan obliges himself to the greatest of the *Magicians*, are wonderful curious; so are the effects correspondent unto the same: For he will oblige himself to teach them arts and sciences, which he may easily do, being so learned a knave as he is: To carry them news from any part of the world, which the agility of a Spirit may easily perform: to reveal to them the secrets of any persons, so being they be once spoken, for the thought none knows but GOD; except so far as you may guess by their countenance, as one who is doubtless learned, enough in the *Physiognomy*: Yes, he will make his scholars to creep in credit with Princes, by fore-telling them many great things; part true, part false: For if all were false, he would tin credit at all hands; but always doubtful, as his Oracles were. And he will also make them to please Princes, by fair banquets and dainty dishes, carried in short space from the farthest part of the world. For no man doubts but he is a thief, and his agility (as I spoke before) makes him to come such speed. Such-like, he will guard his scholars with fair armies of horse-men and footmen in appearance, castles and forts: Which all are but impressions in the air, easily gathered by a spirit, drawing so near to that substance himself: As in like manner he will learn them many jugglery tricks at Guards, dice, and such like, to deceive men's senses thereby: and such innumerable false practices; which are proven by over-mani in this age: As they who are acquainted with that *Italian* called SCOTO yet living, can report. And yet are all these things but deluding of the senses, and no ways true in substance, as were the false miracles wrought by King *Pharaoh's* Magicians, for counterfeiting *Moses*: For that is the difference between God's miracles and the Devils, God is a creator, what he makes appear in miracle, it is so in effect. As *Moses* rod being cast down, was no doubt turned in a natural Serpent: where as the Devil (as Gods Ape) counterfeiting that by his *Magicians*, made their wands to appear so, only to men's outward senses: as appeared in effect by their being devoured by the other. For it is no wonder, that the Devil may delude our senses, since we see by common proof, that simply jugglers will make an hundred things seem both to our eyes and ears otherwise then they are. Now as to the *Magicians* part of the contract, it is in a word that thing, which I said before, the Devil hunts for in all men.

Phi. Surely you have said much to me in this art, if all that you have said be as true as wonderful.

Epi. For the truth in these actions, it will be easily confirmed, to any that pleases to take pain upon the reading of diverse authentic histories, and the inquiring of daily experiences. And as for the truth of their possibility, that they may be, and in what manner, I trust I have alleged nothing whereunto I have not joined such probable reasons, as I leave to your discretion, to wai and consider: One word only I omitted; concerning the form of making of this contract, which is either written with the *Magicians* own blood: or else being agreed upon (in terms his schoolmaster) touches him in some part, though perhaps no mark remain: as it does with all Witches.

CHAPTER VII.

ARGUMENT.

The reason why the art of Magic is unlawful. What punishment they merit: And who may be accounted guilty of that crime.

Philomathes. Surely You have made this art to appear very monstrous and detestable. But what I pray you shall be said to such as maintains this art to be lawful, for as evil as you have made it?

Epi. I say, they savour of the pane themselves, or at least little better, And yet I would be glad to hear their reasons.

Phi. There are two principally, that ever I heard used; beside that which is founded upon the common Proverb (that the *Necromancers* commands the Devil, which you have already refuted). The one is grounded upon a received custom: The other upon an authority, which some thinks infallible. Upon custom, we see that diverse Christian Princes and Magistrates severe punishers of Witches, will not only over-see *Magicians* to live within their dominions; but even some-times delight to see them prove some of their practices. The other reason is, that *Moses* being brought up (as it is expressly said in the Scriptures) *in all the sciences of the Egyptians*; whereof no doubt, this was one of the principals. And he notwithstanding of this art, pleasing God, as he did, consequently that art professed by so godly a man, could not be unlawful.

Epi. As to the first of your reasons, grounded upon custom: I say, an evil custom can never be accepted for a good law, for the over great ignorance of the word in some Princes and Magistrates, and the contempt thereof in others, moves them to sin heavily against their office in that point. As to the other reason, which seems to be of greater weight, if it were formed in a Syllogism; it behooved to be in many terms, and full of fallacies (to speak in terms of *Logic*) for first, that that general proposition; affirming *Moses* to be taught *in all the sciences of the Egyptians*, should conclude that he was taught in *Magic*, I see no necessity. For we must understand that the spirit of God there, speaking of sciences, understands them that are lawful; for except they be lawful, they are but *abusivè* called sciences, and are but ignorance indeed: *Nam homo pictus, non est homo*. Secondly, giving that he had been

taught in it, there is great difference, between knowledge and practising of a thing (as I said before). For God knows all things, being always good, and of our sin and our infirmity proceeds our ignorance. Thirdly, giving that he had both studied and practised the same (which is more than monstrous to be believed by any Christian) yet we know well enough, that before that ever the spirit of God began to call *Moses*, he was fled out of *Egypt*, being forty years of age, for the slaughter of an *Egyptian*, and in his good-father *Jethro's* land, first called at the fiery bush, having remained there other forty years in exile: so that suppose he had been the wicked man in the world before, he then became a changed and regenerate man, and very little of old *Moses* remained in him. *Abraham* was an Idolater in *Vr* of *Called* *Ālea*, before he was called: And *Paul* being called *Saul*, was a most sharp persecutor of the Saints of God, while that name was changed.

Phi. What punishment then think you merits these *Magicians* and *Necromancers*?

Epi. The like no doubt, that *Sorcerers* and *Witches* merits; and rather so much greater, as their error proceeds of the greater knowledge, and so draws nearer to the sin against the holy Ghost. And as I say of them, so say I the like of all such as consults, inquires, entertains, and oversees them, which is seen by the miserable ends of many that asks counsel of them: For the Devil has never better tidings to tell to any, then he told to *Saul*: neither is it lawful to use so unlawful instruments, were it never for so good a purpose: for that axiom in Theology is most certain and infallible: (M14) *Nunquam faciendum est malum vt bonum ind eveniat.*

SECOND BOOK.

ARGUMENT.

The description of Sorcery and Witchcraft in special.

CHAPTER I.

ARGUMENT.

Proved by the Scripture, that such a thing can be: And the reasons refuted of all such as would call it but an imagination and Melancholic humor.

Philomathes. Now since you have satisfied me now so fully, concerning *Magic* or *Necromancy* I will pray you to do the like in *Sorcery* or *Witchcraft*.

Epi. That field is likewise very large: and although in the mouths and pens of many, yet few knows the truth thereof, so well as they believe themselves, as I shall so shortly as I can, make you (God willing) as easily to perceive.

Phi. But I pray you before you go further, let me interrupt you here with a short digression: which is, that many can scarcely believe that there is such a thing as *Witchcraft*. Whose reasons I will shortly allege unto you, that you may satisfy me as well in that, as you have done in the rest. For first, whereas the Scripture seems to prove *Witchcraft* to be, by diverse examples, and especially by sundry of the same, which you have alleged, it is thought by some, that these places speaks of *Magicians* and *Necromancers* only, and not of *Witches*. As in special, these wise men of *Pharaohs*, that counterfeited *Moses* miracles, were *Magicians* say they, and not *Witches*: As likewise that *Pythoness* that *Saul* consulted with: And so was *Simon Magus* in the new Testament, as that very style imports. Secondly, where you would oppose the daily practice, & confession of so many, that is thought likewise to be but very melancholic imaginations of simply raving creatures. Thirdly, if *Witches* had such power of *Witching* of folks to death, (as they say they have) there had been none left alive long sense in the world, but they: at the least, no good or godly person of whatsoever estate, could have escaped their devilry.

Epi. Your three reasons as I take, are grounded the first of them *negative* upon the Scripture: The second *affirmative* upon *Physic*: And the third upon the certain proof of experience. As to your first, it is most true indeed, that all these wise men of *Pharaoh* were *Magicians* of art: As likewise it appears well that the *Pythoness*, with whom *Saul* consulted, was of that same profession: and so was *Simon Magus*. But you omitted to speak of the Law

of God, wherein are all *Magicians*, Divines, Enchanters, Sorcerers, Witches, and whatsoever of that kind that consults with the Devil, plainly prohibited, and alike threatened against. And besides that, she who had the Spirit of *Python*, in the Acts, (M15) whose Spirit was put to silence by the Apostle, could be no other thing but a very Sorcerer or Witch, if you admit the vulgar distinction, to be in a manner true, whereof I spoke in the beginning of our conference. For that spirit whereby she conquered such gain to her Master, was not at her raising or commanding, as she pleased to appoint, but spoke by her tongue, as well publicly, as privately: Whereby she seemed to draw nearer to the sort of *Demoniacs* or possessed, if that conjunction between them, had not been of her own consent: as it appeared by her, not being tormented therewith: And by her conquering of such gain to her masters (as I have already said.) As to your second reason grounded upon Physic, in attributing their confessions or apprehensions, to a natural melancholic humour: Any that pleases Physically to consider upon the natural humour of melancholy, according to all the Physicians, that ever writ thereupon, they shall find that that will be over short a cloak to cover their knavery with: For as the humor of Melancholy in the self is black, heavy and earthly, so are the symptoms thereof, in any persons that are subject to it, leans, paleness, desire of solitude: and if they come to the highest degree thereof, mere folly and *Many*: where as by the contrary, a great number of them that ever have been convict or confessors of Witchcraft, as may be presently seen by many that have at this time confessed: they are by the contrary, I say, some of them rich and worldly-wise, some of them fate or corpulent in their bodies, and most part of them altogether given over to the pleasures of the flesh, continual haunting of company, and all kind of merriness, both lawful and unlawful, which are things directly contrary to the symptoms of Melancholy, whereof I spoke, and further experience daily proves how loath they are to confess without torture, which witnesses their guiltiness, where by the contrary, the Melancholic never spares to betray themselves, by their continual discourses, feeding thereby their humor in that which they think no crime. As to your third reason, it scarcely merits an answer. For if the devil their master were not bridled, as the scriptures teaches us, suppose there were no men nor women to be his instruments, he could find ways enough without any help of others to wreck all mankind: to which he employs his whole study, and *goes about like a roaring Lyon* (as PETER says) (M16) to that effect, but the limits of his power were set down before the foundations of the world were laid, which he has not power in the least jot to transgress. But beside all this, there is over great a certainty to prove that they are, by the daily experience of the harms that they do, both to men, and whatsoever thing men possesses, whom God will permit them to be the instruments, so to trouble or visit, as in my discourse of that art, you shall hear clearly proved.

CHAPTER II.

ARGUMENT.

The Etymology and signification of that word of Sorcery. The first entrance and apprenticeship of them that gives themselves to that craft.

Philomathes. Come on then I pray you, and return where you left.

Epi. This word of *Sorcery* is a *Latin* word, which is taken from casting of the lot, and therefore he that uses it, is called *Sortiarius à sort*. As to the word of *Witchcraft*, it is nothing but a proper name given in our language. The cause wherefore they were called *sortiarij*, proceeded of their practices seeming to come of lot or chance: Such as the turning of the riddle: the knowing of the form of prayers, or such like tokens: If a person diseased would live or dye. And in general, that name was given them for using of such charms, and omens, as that Craft teaches them. Many points of their craft and practices are common between the *Magicians* and them: for they serve both one Master, although in diverse fashions. And as I divided the *Necromancers*, into two sorts, learned and unlearned; so must I deny them in other two, rich and of better account, poor and of meaner degree. These two degrees now of persons, that practices this craft, answers to the passions in them, which (I told you before) the Devil used as means to entice them to his service, for such of them as are in great misery and poverty, he allures to follow him, by promising unto them great riches, and worldly commodity. Such as though rich, yet burns in a desperate desire of revenge, he allures them by promises, to get their turn satisfied to their hearts contentment. It is to be noted now, that that old and crafty enemy of ours, assails none, though touched with any of these two extremities, except he first find an entrance ready for him, either by the great ignorance of the person he deals with, joined with an evil life, or else by their carelessness and contempt of God: And finding them in an utter despair, for one of these two former causes that I have spoken of; he prepares the way by feeding them craftily in their humour, and filling them further and further with despair, while he find the time proper to discover himself unto them. At which time, either upon their walking solitary in the fields, or else lying pondering in their bed; but always without the company of any other, he either by a voice, or in likeness of a man inquires of them, what troubles them: and promises them, a sudden and certain wai of remedy, upon condition on the other part, that they follow his advise; and do such things as he will require of them: Their minds being prepared before hand, as I have already spoken, they easily agreed unto that demand of his: And then sets an other tryst, where they may meet again. At which time, before he proceed any further with them, he first persuades them to addict themselves to his service: which being easily obtained, he then discovers what he is unto them: makes them to renounce their God and *Baptism* directly, and gives them his mark upon some secret place of their body, which remains soar unhealed, while his next meeting with them, and thereafter ever insensible, how soever it be nipped or pricked by any, as is daily proved, to give them a proof thereby, that as in that doing, he could hurt and heal them; so all their ill and well doing thereafter, must depend upon him. And besides that, the intolerable grief that they feel in that place, where he has marked them, serves to waken them, and not to let them rest, while their next meeting again: fearing least otherwise they might either forget him, being as new Apprentices, and not well enough founded yet, in that fiendish folly: or else remembering of that horrible promise they made him, at their last meeting, they might shun at the same, and press to call it back. At their

third meeting, he makes a show to be careful to perform his promises, either by teaching them ways how to get themselves revenged, if they be of that sort: Or else by teaching them lessons, how by most vile and unlawful means, they may obtain gain, and worldly commodity, if they be of the other sort.

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

*The Witches actions divided in two parts. The actions proper to their own persons.
Their actions toward others. The form of their conventions, and adoring of their Master.*

Philomathes. You have said now enough of their initiating in that filth. It rests then that you discourse upon their practices, from they be passed Apprentices: for I would gladly hear what is possible to them to perform in very deed. Although they serve a common Master with the *Necromancers*, (as I have before said) yet serve they him in an other form. For as the means are diverse, which allures them to these unlawful arts of serving of the Devil; so by diverse ways use they their practices, answering to these means, which first the Devil, used as instruments in them; though all tending to one end: To wit, the enlarging of Satan's tyranny, and crossing of the propagation of the Kingdom of CHRIST, so farr as lis in the possibility, either of the one or other sort, or of the Devil their Master. For where the *Magicians*, as allured by curiosity, in the most part of their practices, seeks principally the satisfying of the same, and to winn to themselves a popular honour and estimation: These Witches on the other part, being enticed ether for the desire of revenge, or of worldly riches, their whole practices are either to hurt men and their goods, or what they possess, for satisfying of their cruel minds in the former, or else by the wreck in whatsoever sort, of any whom God will permit them to have power off, to satisfy their greedy desire in the last point.

Epi. In two parts their actions may be divided; the actions of their own persons, and the actions proceeding from them towards any other. And this division being well understood, will easily resolve you, what is possible to them to do. For although all that they confess is no lie upon their part, yet doubtless in my opinion, a part of it is not indeed, according as they take it to be: And in this I mean by the actions of their own persons. For as I said before, speaking of *Magic* that the Devil eludes the senses of these scholars of his, in many things, so say I the like of these Witches.

Phi. Then I pray you, first to speak of that part of their own persons, and then you may come next to their actions towards others.

Epi. To the effect that they may perform such services of their false Master, as he employs them in, the devil as Gods Ape, counterfeits in his servants this service and form of adoration, that God prescribed and made his servants to practice. For as the servants of GOD, publicly uses to convene for serving of him, so makes he them in great numbers to convene (though publicly they dare not) for his service. As none convenes to the adoration and worshiping of God, except they be marked with his scale, the Sacrament of *Baptism*: So

none serves Satan, and convenes to the adoring of him, that are not marked with that mark, whereof I already spoke. As the Minister sent by God, teaches plainly at the time of their public conventions, how to serve him in spirit and truth: so that unclean spirit, in his own person teaches his Disciples, at the time of their convening, how to work all kind of mischief: And craves account of all their horrible and detestable proceedings passed, for advancement of his service. Yes, that he may the more vividly counterfeit and scorn God, he often times makes his slaves to convene in these very places, which are destined and ordained for the convening of the servants of God (I mean by Churches). But this farr, which I have yet said, I not only take it to be true in their opinions, but even so to be indeed. For the form that he used in counterfeiting God amongst the *Gentiles*, makes me so to think: As God spoke by his Oracles, spoke he not so by his? As GOD had as well bloody Sacrifices, as others without blood, had not he the like? As God had Churches sanctified to his service, with Altars, Priests, Sacrifices, Ceremonies and Prayers; had he not the like polluted to his service? As God gave responses by *Urim* and *Thummim*, gave he not his responses by the entrails of beasts, by the singing of Fowls, and by their actions in the air? As God by visions, dreams, and ecstasies revealed what was to come, and what was his will unto his servants; used he not the like means to forewarn his slaves of things to come? Yes, even as God loved cleans, hated vice, and impurity, and appointed punishments therefore: used he not the like (though falsely I grant, and but in eschewing the less inconvenient, to draw them upon a greater) yet dissembled he not I say, so farr as to appoint his Priests to keep their bodies clean and undefiled, before their asking responses of him? And feigned he not God to be a protector of every virtue, and a just revenger of the contrary? This reason then moves me, that as he is that same Devil; and as crafty now as he was then; so will he not spare a openly in these actions that I have spoken of, concerning the witches persons: But further, Witches often times confesses not only his convening in the Church with them, but his occupying of the Pulpit: Yes, their form of adoration, to be the kissing of his hinder parts. Which though it seem ridiculous, yet may it likewise be true, seeing we read that in *Calicut*, he appearing in form of a *Goat-buck*, has publicly that vn-hon homage done unto him, by every one of the people: So ambitious is he, and greedy of honour (which procured his fall) that he will even imitate God in that part, (M17) where it is said, that *Moses* could see but the *hinder parts of God, for the brightness of his glory*: And yet that speech is spoken but *αυθροωπαθειαν*.

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

What are the ways possible, whereby the witches may transport themselves to places far distant, And what are impossible and mere illusions of Satan. And the reasons thereof.

Philomathes. But by what way say they or think you it possible that they can com to these unlawful cōuentiōs?

Epi. There is the thing which I esteem their senses to be deluded in, and though they ly not in confessing of it, because they think it to be true, yet not to be so in substance or effect: for they say, that by diverse means they may convene, either to the adoring of their Master, or to the putting in practice any service of his, committed unto their charge: one way is natural, which is natural riding, going or sailing, at what hour their Master comes and advertises them. And this way may be easily believed: an other way is some-what more strange: and yet is it possible to be true: which is by being carried by the force of the Spirit which is their conductor, either above the earth or above the Sea swiftly, to the place where they are to meet: which I am persuaded to be likewise possible, in respect that as *Habakkuk* was carried by the Angel in that form, to the den where *Daniel* lai; (M18) so think I, the Devil will be reddy to imitate God, as well in that as in other things: which is much more possible to him to do, being a Spirit, then to a mighty wind, being but a natural meteor, to transport from one place to an other a solid body, as is commonly and daily seen in practice: But in this violent form they cannot be carried, but a short bounds, agreeing with the space that they may retain their breath: for if it were longer, their breath could not remain unextinguished, their body being carried in such a violent and forcible manner, as be example: If one fall off an small height, his life is but in peril, according to the hard or soft lighting: But if one fall from an high and stay rock, his breath will be forcibly banished from the body, before he can win to the earth, as is often seen by experience. And in this transporting they say themselves, that they are invisible to any other, except amongst themselves; which may also be possible in my opinion. For if the devil may form what kind of impressions he pleases in the air, as I have said before, speaking of *Magic*, why may he not far easier thicken and obscure so the air, that is next about them by contracting it strait together, that the beams of any other mans eyes, cannot pearce through the same, to see them? But the third way of their coming to their conventions, is, that where in I think them deluded: for some of them says, that being transformed in the likeness of a little beast or foul, they will come and pearce through whatsoever house or Church, though all ordinary passages be closed, by whatsoever open, the air may enter in at. And some says, that their bodies lying still as in an ecstasy, their spirits will be ravished out of their bodies, and carried to such places. And for verifying thereof, will give evident tokens, as well by witnesses that have seen their body lying senseless in the mean time, as by naming persons, with whom they met, and giving tokens what purpose was amongst them, whom otherwise they could not have known: for this form of journeying, they affirm to use most, when they are transported from one Country to another.

Phi. Surely I long to hear your own opinion of this: For they are like old wives chatter about the fire. The reasons that moves me to think that these are mere illusions, are these. First for them that are transformed in likeness of beasts or foulds, can enter through so narrow passages, although I may easily believe that the Devil could by his workmanship upon the air, make them appear to be in such forms, either to themselves or to others: Yet how he can contract a solid body within so little room, I think it is directly contrary to

itself, for to be made so little, and yet not diminished: To be so strictly drawn together, and yet feel no pain; I think it is so contrary to the quality of a natural body, and so like to the little transubstantiated god in the *Papists Mass*, that I can never believe it. So to have a quantity, is so proper to a solid body, that as all Philosophers conclude, it cannot be any more without one, then a spirit can have one. For when PETER *came out of the prison, (M19) and the doors all locked*: It was not by any contracting of his body in so little room: but by the giving place of the dor, though unnoticed by the Jailers. And yet is there no comparison, when this is done, between the power of God, and of the Devil. As to their form of ecstasy and spiritual transporting, it is certain the souls going out of the body, is the only definition of natural death: and who are once dead, God forbid we should think that it should lie in the power of all the Devils in Hell, to restore them to their life again: Although he can put his own spirit in a dead body, which the *Necromancers* commonly practice, as you have hard. For that is the office properly belonging to God; and besides that, the soul once parting from the body, cannot wander any longer in the world, but to the own resting place must it go immediately, abiding the conjunction of the body again, at the latter dai. And what CHRIST or the Prophets did miraculously in this case, it cannot in no Christian mans opinion be maid common with the Devil. As for any tokens that they give for proving of this, it is very possible to the Devil's craft, to persuade them to these means. For he being a spirit, may he not so ravish their thoughts, and dull their senses, that their body lying as dead, he may object to their spirits as it were in a dream, and (as the Poets write of *Morpheus*) represent such forms of persons, of places, and other circumstances, as he pleases to elude them with? Yes, that he may deceive them with the greater efficacy, may he not at that same instant, by fellow angeles of his, elude such other persons so in that same fashion, whom with he makes them to believe that they met; that all their reports and tokens, though severally examined, may every one agree with an other. And that whatsoever actions, either in hurting men or beasts: or whatsoever other thing that they falsely imagine, at that time to have done, may by himself or his marrows, at that same time be done indeed; so as if they would give for a token of their being ravished at the death of such a person within so short space thereafter, whom they believe to have poisoned, or bewitched at that instant, might he not at that same hour, have smitten that same person by the permission of GOD, to the farther deceiving of them, and to move others to believe them? And this is surely the likely way, and most according to reason, which my judgment can find out in this, and whatsoever other unnatural points of their confession. And by these means shall we sail surely, between *Charybdis* and *Scylla*, in eschewing the not believing of them altogether on the one part, least that draw us to the error that there is no Witches: and on the other part in believing of it, make us to eschew the falling into innumerable absurdities, both monstrously against all Theology divine, and Philosophy human.

CHAPTER V.

ARGUMENT.

*Witches actions towards others. Why there are more women of that craft than men?
What things are possible to them to effectuate by the power of their master. The reasons
thereof. What is the sur remedy of the harms done by them.*

Philomathes. Indeed your opinion in this, seems to carrie most reason with it, and sense you have ended, then the actions belonging properly to their own persons: say forward now to their actions used towards others.

Epi. In their actions used towards others, three things ought to be considered: First the manner of their consulting thereupon: Next their part as instruments: And last their masters part, who puts the same in execution. As to their consultations thereupon, they use them oft in the Churches, where they convene for adoring: at what time their master inquiring at them what they would be at: every one of them proposes unto him, what wicked turn they would have done, either for obtaining of riches, or for revenging them upon any whom they have malice at: who granting their demand, as no doubt willingly he will, since it is to do evil, he teaches them the means, whereby they may do the same. As for little trifling turns that women have ado with, he causes them to joint dead corpses, and to make powders thereof, mixing such other things there amongst, as he gives unto them.

Phi. But before you go further, permit me I pray you to interrupt you one word, which you have put me in memory of, by speaking of Women. What can be the cause that there are twenty women given to that craft, where there is one man?

Epi. The reason is easy, for as that sex is frailer then man is, so is it easier to be entrapped in these gross snares of the Devil, as was over well proved to be true, by the Serpents deceiving of *Eva* at the beginning, which makes him the homelier with that sex since.

Phi. Return now where you left.

Epi. To some others at these times he teaches how to make Pictures of wax or clay: That by the roasting thereof, the persons that they bear the name of, may be continually melted or dried away by continual sickness. To some he gives such stones or powders, as will help to cure or cast on diseases: And to some he teaches kinds of uncouth poisons, which Doctors understands not (for he is farr more cunning then man in the knowledge of all the occult properties of nature) not that any of these means which he teaches them (except the poisons which are composed of things natural) can of themselves help any thing to these turns, that they are employed in, but only being Gods Ape, as well in that, as in all other things. Even as God by his Sacraments which are earthly of themselves works a heavenly effect, though no ways by any cooperation in them: And (M20) as CHRIST by clay and spittle wrought together, *opened the eis of the blind man*, suppose there was no virtue in that which he outwardly applied, so the Devil will have his out-ward means to be shows as it were of his doing, which has no part of cooperation in his turns with him, how farr that ever the ignorant be abused in the contrary. And as to the effects of these two former parts, to wit, the consultations and the outward means, they are so wonderful as I dare not allege any of them, without joining a sufficient reason of the possibility thereof.

For leaving all the small trifles among wives, and to speak of the principal points of their craft. For the common trifles thereof, they can do without converting well enough by themselves: These principal points I say are these: They can make men or women to love or hate other, which may be very possible to the Devil to effectual, seeing he being a subtle spirit, knows well enough how to persuade the corrupted affection of them whom God will permit him so to deal with: They can lay the sickness of one upon an other, which likewise is very possible unto him: For since by Gods permission, he laid sickness upon JOB, why may he not farr easier lay it upon any other: For as an old practitioner, he knows well enough what humor dominates most in any of us, and as a spirit he can subtly walk up the same, making it sinful, or to abound, as he thinks meet for troubling of us, when God will so permit him. And for the taking off of it, no doubt he will be glad to relive such of present pain, as he may think by these means to persuade to be caught in his everlasting snares and fetters. They can be-witch and take the life of men or women, by roasting of the Pictures, as I spoke of before, which likewise is very possible to their Master to perform, for although, (as I said before) that instrument of wax have no virtue in that turn doing, yet may he not very well even by that same measure that his conjured slaves melts that wax at the fire, may he not I say at these same times, subtly as a spirit so weaken and scatter the spirits of life of the patient, as may make him on th'one part, for faintness to sweat out the humour of his body: And on the other part, for the not concurrence of these spirits, which causes his digestion, so debilitated his stomach, that his humour radical continually, sweating out on the one part, and no new good suck being put in the place thereof, for lack of digestion on the other, he at last shall vanish away, even as his picture will do at the fire. And that knavish and cunning workman, by troubling him only at some times, makes a proportion so near between the working of the one and the other, that both shall end as it were at one time. They can rays storms and tempests in the air, either upon Sea or land, though not universally, but in such a particular place and prescribed bounds, as God will permit them so to trouble: Which likewise is very easy to be discerned from any other natural tempests that are meteors, in respect of the sudden and violent raising thereof, together with the short enduring of the same. And this is likewise very possible to their master to do, he having such affinity with the air as being a spirit, and having such power of the forming and moving thereof, as you have heard me already declare: For in the Scripture, that style of *the Prince of the air* (M21) is given unto him. They can make folks to become frenzied or Maniac, which likewise is very possible to their master to do, sense they are but natural sickness: and so he may lay on these kinds, as well as any others. They can make spirits either to follow and trouble persons, or haunt certain houses, and afraid oftentimes the inhabitants: as has been known to be done by our Witches at this time. And likewise they can make some to be possessed with spirits, and so to become very Demoniacs: and this last sort is very possible likewise to the Devil their Master to do, since he may easily send his own angels to trouble in what form he pleases, any whom God will permit him so to use.

Phi. But will God permit these wicked instruments by the power of the Devil their master, to trouble by any of these means, any that believes in him?

Epi. No doubt, for there are three kind of folks whom God will permit so to be tempted or troubled; the wicked for their horrible sins, to punish them in the like measure; The godly that are sleeping in any great sins or infirmities and weakens in faith, to waken them up the faster by such an uncouth form: and even some of the best, that their patience may be tried before the world, as JOB'S was. For why may not God use any kind of extraordinary punishment, when it pleases him; as well as the ordinary rods of sickness or other adversities.

Phi. Who then may be free from these Devilish practices?

Epi. No man ought to presume so far as to promise any impunity to himself: for God has before all beginnings preordained as well the particular sorts of Plagues as of benefits for every man, which in the own time he ordains them to be visited with, and yet ought we not to be the more afraid for that, of any thing that the Devil and his wicked instruments can do against us: For we daily fight against the Devil in a hundred other ways: And therefore as a valiant Captain, frightens no more being at the combat, than stays from his purpose for the rumbling shot of a Cannon, nor the small clack of a Pistol: suppose he be not certain what may light upon him; Even so ought we boldly to go forward in fighting against the Devil without any greater terror, for these his rare weapons, than for the ordinary whereof we have daily the proof.

Phi. Is it not lawful then by the help of some other Witch to cure the disease that is cast on by that craft?

Epi. No ways lawful: For I gave you the reason thereof in that axiom of Theology, which was the last words I spoke of *Magic*.

Phi. How then may these diseases be lawfully cured?

Epi. Only by earnest prayer to GOD, by amendment of their lives, and by sharp pursuing every one, according to his calling of these instruments of Satan, whose punishment to the death will be a salutary sacrifice for the patient. And this is not only the lawful way, but likewise the most sure: For by the Devil's means, *can never the Devil be cast out*, (M22) as Christ says. And when such a cure is used, it may well serve for a short time, but at the last, it will doubtless tend to the utter perdition of the patient, both in body and soul.

CHAPTER VI.

ARGUMENT.

What sort of folks are least or most subject to receive harm by Witchcraft. What power they have to harm the Magistrate, and upon what respects they have any power in prison: And to what end may or will the Devil appear to them therein. Upon what respects the Devil appears in sundry shapes to sundry of them at any time.

Philomathes. But who dare take upon him to punish them, if no man can be sure to be free from their unnatural invasions?

Epi. We ought not the more of that restrain from virtue, that the way whereby we climb to it be straight and perilous. But besides that, as there is no kind of persons so subject to receive harm of them, as these that are of infirm and weak faith (which is the best buckler against such invasions:) so have they so small power over none, as over such as zealously and earnestly pursues them, without sparing for any worldly respect.

Phi. Then they are like the Pest, which strikes these sickest, that flies it farthest, and apprehends deeply the peril thereof.

Epi. It is even so with them: For neither is it able to them to use any false cure upon a patient, except the patient first believe in their power, and so hazard the loss of his own soul, nor yet can they have less power to hurt any, than such as despises most their doings, so being it comes of faith, and not of any vain arrogance in themselves.

Phi. But what is their power against the Magistrate?

Epi. Less or greater, according as he deals with them. For if he be slothful towards them, God is very able to make them instruments to waken and punish his sloth. But if he be the contrary, he according to the just law of God, and allowable law of all Nations, will be diligent in examining and punishing of them: GOD will not permit their master to trouble or hinder so good a work.

Phi. But from they be once in hands and assurance, have they any further power in their craft?

Epi. That is according to the form of their detention. If they be but apprehended and detained by any private person, upon other private respects, their power no doubt either in escaping, or in doing hurt, is no less than ever it was before. But if on the other part, their apprehending and detention be by the lawful Magistrate, upon the just respects of their guiltiness in that craft, their power is then no greater then before that ever they meddled with their master. For where God begins justly to strike by his lawful Lieutenants, it is not in the Devil's power to defraud or bereave him of the office, or effect of his powerful and revenging Scepter.

Phi. But will never their master come to visit them, from they be once apprehended and put in assurance?

Epi. That is according to the estate that these miserable wretches are in: For if they be obstinate in still denying, he will not spare, when he finds time to speak with them, either if he find them in any comfort, to fill them more and more with the vain hope of some manner of relief: or else if he find them in a deep despair, by all means to augment the same, and to persuade them by some extraordinary means to put themselves down, which very commonly they do. But if they be penitent and confess, God will not permit him to trouble them any more with his presence and enticements.

Phi. It is not good using his counsel I see then. But I would earnestly know when he appears to them in Prison, what forms uses he then to take?

Epi. Divers forms, even as he uses to do at other times unto them. For as I told you, speaking of *Magic*, he appears to that kind of craftsmen ordinarily in an form, according as they agree upon it amongst themselves: Or if they be but apprentices, according to the quality of their circles or conjurations: Yet to these capped creatures, he appears as he pleases, and as he finds meet for their humors. For even at their public conventions, he appears to divers of them in divers forms, as we have found by the difference of their confessions in that point: For he deluding them with vain impressions in the air, makes himself to seem more terrible to the grosser sort, that they may thereby be moved to fear and reverence him the more: And les monstrous and strange again to the craftier sort, least otherwise they might stir and shun at his ugliness.

Phi. How can he then be felt, as they confess they have done him, if his body be but of air?

Epi. I hear little of that amongst their confessions, yet may he make himself palpable, either by assuming any dead body, and using the ministry thereof, or else by deluding as well their sense of feeling as seeing; which is not impossible to him to do, since all our senses, as we are so weak, and even by ordinary sickness will be often times deluded.

Phi. But I would sphere one word further yet, concerning his appearing to them in prison, which is this. May any other that chances to be present at that time in the prison, see him as well as they.

Epi. Some-times they will, and some-times not, as it pleases God.

CHAPTER VII.

ARGUMENT.

Two forms of the devils' visible conversing in the earth, with the reasons wherefore the one of them was commune in the time of Popery: And the other since. Those that denies the power of the Devil, denies the power of God, and are guilty of the error of the Sadducees.

Philomathes. Has the Devil then power to appear to any other, except to such as are his sworn disciples: especially since all Oracles, and such like kinds of illusions were taken away and abolished by the cumming of CHRIST?

Epi. Although it be true indeed, that the brightness of the Gospel at his cumming, scaled the clouds of all these gross errors in the Paganism: yet that these abusing spirits, ceases not since at sometimes to appear, daily experience teaches us. Indeed this difference is to be marked between the forms of Satan's conversing visibly in the world. For of two different forms thereof, the one of them by the spreading of the Gospel, and conquest of the white horse, in the sixth Chapter of the Revelation, is much hindered and become rarer there through. This his appearing to any Christians, troubling of them outwardly, or possessing of them reluctantly. The other of them is become commoner and more used since, I mean by their unlawful arts, whereupon our whole purpose has been. This we find by experience in this I'll to be true. For as we know, more Ghosts and spirits were seen,

than tongue can tell, in the time of blind *Popery* in these Countries, where now by the contrary, a man shall scarcely all his time here once of such things. And yet were these unlawful arts farr rarer at that time: and never were so much hard of, than so rife as they are now.

Phi. What should be the cause of that?

Epi. The diverse nature of our sins procures at the Justice of God, diverse sorts of punishments answering to it. And therefore as in the time of *Popery*, our fathers erring grossly, and through ignorance, that mist of errors overshadowed the Devil to walk the more familiarly amongst them: And as it were by plainly and frightening terrors, to mock and accuse their plainly errors. By the contrary, we now being sound of Religion, and in our life rebelling to our profession, God justly by that sin of rebellion, as *Samuel* calls it, accuses our life so willfully fighting against our profession.

Phi. Since you are entered now to speak of the appearing of spirits: I would be glad to hear your opinion in that matter. For many denies that any such spirits can appear in these days as I have said.

Epi. Doubtless who denies the power of the Devil, would likewise deny the power of God, if they could for shame. For since the Devil is the very contrary opposite to God, there can be no better way to know God, then by the contrary; as by the ones power (though a creature) to admire the power of the great Creator: by the falsehood of the one to consider the truth of the other, by the injustice of the one, to consider the Justice of the other: And by the cruelty of the one, to consider the mercifulness of the other: And so forth in all the rest of the essence of God, and qualities of the Devil. But I fear indeed, there be over many *Sadducees* in this world, that denies all kinds of spirits: For convicting of whose error, there is cause enough if there were no more, that God should permit at sometimes spirits visibly to show.

THIRD BOOK.

ARGUMENT.

The description of all these kinds of Spirits that troubles men or women. The conclusion of the whole Dialogue.

CHAPTER I.

ARGUMENT.

The division of spirits in four principal kinds. The description of the first kind of them, called Spectra and umbrae mortuorum. What is the best way to be free of their trouble.

Philomathes. I pray you now then go forward in telling what you think fabulous, or may be believed in that case.

Epi. That kind of the Devils' conversing in the earth, may be divided in four different kinds, whereby he frightens and troubles the bodies of men: For of the abusing of the soul, I have spoken already. The first is, where spirits troubles some houses or solitary places: The second, where spirits follows upon certain persons, and at divers hours troubles them: The third, when they enter within them and possess them: The fourth is these kind of spirits that are called commonly the Fairy. Of the three former kinds, you hard already, how they may artificially be made by Witchcraft to trouble folk: Now it rests to speak of their natural coming as it were, and not raised by Witchcraft. But generally I must for-warn you of one thing before I enter in this purpose: that is, that although in my discoursing of them, I divide them in divers kinds, you must notwithstanding there of note my Phrase of speaking in that: For doubtless they are in effect, but all one kind of spirits, who for abusing the more of mankind, takes on these sundry shapes, and uses diverse forms of out-ward actions, as if some were of nature better then other. Now I return to my purpose: As to the first kind of these spirits, that were called by the ancients by divers names, according as their actions were. For if they were spirits that haunted some houses, by appearing in divers and horrible forms, and making great dine: they were called *Lemures* or *Spectra*. If they appeared in likeness of any defunct to some friends of his, they were called *umbrae mortuorum*: And so innumerable stiles they got, according to their actions, as I have said already. As we see by experience, how many stiles they have given them in our language in the like manner: Of the appearing of these spirits, we are certified by the Scriptures, where the Prophet ISAIAH 13. (M23) and 34. cap. threatening the destruction of *Babel* and *Edom*: declares, that it shall not only be wrecked, but shall become so great a

solitude, as it shall be the dwelling of Owlets, and of ZIIM and IIM, which are the proper Hebrew names for these Spirits. The cause why they haunt solitary places, it is by reason, that they may afraid and brawl the more the faith of such as them alone haunts such places. For our nature is such, as in companies we are not so soon moved to any such kind of fear, as being solitary, which the Devil knowing well enough, he will not therefore assail us but when we are weak: And besides that, GOD will not permit him so to dishonor the societies and companies of Christians, as in public times and places to walk visibly amongst them. On the other part, when he troubles certain houses that are dwelt in, it is a sure token either of gross ignorance, or of some gross and slanderous sins amongst the inhabitants thereof: which God by that extraordinary rod punishes.

Phi. But by what way or passage can these Spirits enter in these houses, seeing they allege that they will enter, Door and Window being shut?

Epi. They will choose the passage for their entrance, according to the form that they are in at that time. For if they have assumed a dead body, into which they lodge themselves, they can easily enough open without dine any Door or Window, and enter in thereat. And if they enter as a spirit only, any place where the air may come in at, is large enough an entry for them: For as I said before, a spirit can occupy no quantity.

Phi. And will God then permit these wicked spirits to trouble the rest of a dead body, before the resurrection thereof? Or if he will so, I think it should be of the reprobate only.

Epi. What more is the rest troubled of a dead body, when the Devil carries it out of the Grave to serve his turn for a space, nor when the Witches takes it up and joints it, or when as Swine herbs vp the graves? The rest of them that the Scripture speaks of, is not meant by a local remaining continually in one place, but by their resting from their travels and miseries of this world, while their latter conjunction again with the soul at that time to receive full glory in both. And that the Devil may use as well the ministry of the bodies of the faithful in these cases, as of the vn-faithful, there is no inconvenient; for his haunting with their bodies after they are dead, can no-ways defile them: In respect of the souls absence. And for any dishonor it can be unto them, by what reason can it be greater, then the hanging, heading, or many such shameful deaths, that good men will suffer? for there is nothing in the bodies of the faithful, more worthy of honour, or freer from corruption by nature, than in these of the unfaithful, while time they be purged and glorified in the latter dai, as is daily seen by the vile diseases and corruptions, that the bodies of the faithful are subject unto, as you will see clearly proved, when I speak of the possessed and Demoniacs.

Phi. Yet there are sundry that affirms to have haunted such places, where these spirits are alleged to be: And could never hear nor see any thing.

Epi. I think well: For that is only reserved to the secrete knowledge of God, whom he will permit to see such things, and whom not.

Phi. But where these spirits haunts and troubles any houses, what is the best wai to banish them?

Epi. By two means may only the remedy of such things be procured: The one is ardent prayer to God, both of these persons that are troubled with them, and of that Church whereof they are. The other is the purging of themselves by amendment of life from such sins, as have procured that extraordinary plague.

Phi. And what means then these kinds of spirits, when they appear in the shadow of a person newly dead, or to die, to his friends?

Epi. When they appear upon that occasion, they are called Wraiths in our language. Amongst the *Gentiles* the Devil used that much, to make them believe that it was some good spirit that appeared to them then, ether to forewarn them of the death of their friend; or else to discover unto them, the will of the defunct, or what was the way of his slaughter, as is written in the book of the histories Prodigious. And this way he easily deceived the *Gentiles*, because they knew not God: And to that same effect is it, that he now appears in that manner to some ignorant Christians. For he dare not so elude any that knows that, neither can the spirit of the defunct return to his friend, or yet an Angel use such forms.

Phi. And are not our werewolves one sort of these spirits also, that haunts and troubles some houses or dwelling places?

Epi. There has indeed been an old opinion of such like things; For by the *Greeks* they were called *λυκανθρωποι* which signifies werewolves. But to tell you simply my opinion in this, if any such thing has been, I take it to have proceeded but of a natural super-abundance of Melancholy, which as we read, that it has made some think themselves Pitchers, and some horses, and some one kind of beast or other: So suppose I that it has so vitiated the imagination and memory of some, as *per lucida intervalla*, it has so highly occupied them, that they have thought themselves very Wolves indeed at these times: and so have counterfeited their actions in going on their hands and feet, pressing to devour women and barnes, fighting and snatching with all the town dogs, and in using such like other brutish actions, and so to become beasts by a strong apprehension, (M24) as *Nebuchadnezzar* was seven years: but as to their having and hiding of their hard and shelly sloughs, I take that to be but eked, by uncertain report, the author of all lies.

CHAPTER II.

ARGUMENT.

The description of the next two kinds of Spirits, whereof the one follows outwardly, the other possesses inwardly the persons that they trouble. That since all Prophecies and visions are now ceased, all spirits that appears in these forms are evil.

Philomathes. Come forward now to the rest of these kinds of spirits.

Epi. As to the next two kinds, that is, either these that outwardly troubles and follows some persons, or else inwardly possesses them: I will conjoin them in one, because as well the causes are alike in the persons that they are permitted to trouble: as also the ways whereby they may be remedied and cured.

Phi. What kind of persons are they that uses to be so troubled?

Epi. Two kinds in special: Either such as being guilty of grievous offences, God punishes by that horrible kind of scourge, or else being persons of the best nature perhaps, that you shall find in all the Country about them, GOD permits them to be troubled in that sort, for the trial of their patience, and wakening up of their zeal, for admonishing of the beholders, not to trust over much in themselves, since they are made of no better stuff, and perhaps blotted with no smaller sins (as CHRIST said, (M25) speaking of them upon whom the Tower in *Siloam* fell:) And for giving likewise to the spectators, matter to pray GOD, that they meriting no better, are yet spared from being corrected in that fearful form.

Phi. These are good reasons for the part of GOD, which apparently moves him so to permit the Devil to trouble such persons. But since the Devil has ever a contrary respect in all the actions that GOD employs him in: which is I pray you the end and mark he shoots at in this turn?

Epi. It is to obtain one of two things thereby, if he may: The one is the loss of their life, by inducing them to such perilous places at such time as he either follows or possesses them, which may procure the same: And such like, so farr as GOD will permit him, by tormenting them to weaken their body, and caste them in incurable diseases. The other thing that he presses to obtain by troubling of them, is the loss of their soul, by enticing them to mistrust and blaspheme God: Either for the intolerability of their torments, as he assayed to have done with JOB; (M26) or else for his promising unto them to leave the troubling of them, in case they would so do, as is known by experience at this same time by the confession of a young one that was so troubled.

Phi. Since you have spoken now of both these kinds of spirits comprehending them in one: I must now go back again in asking some questions of every one of these kinds in special. And first for these that follows certain persons, you know that there are two sorts of them: One sort that troubles and torments the persons that they haunt with: An other sort that are serviceable unto them in all kind of their necessities, and omits never to forewarn them of any sudden peril that they are to be in. And so in this case, I would understand whither both these sorts be but wicked and damned spirits: Or if the last sort be rather Angels, (as should appear by their actions) sent by God to assist such as he especially favours. For it is written in the Scriptures, (M27) that *God sends Legions of Angels to guard and watch over his elect.*

Epi. I know well enough where from that error which you allege has proceeded: For it was the ignorant *Gentiles* that were the fountain thereof. Who for that they knew not God, they forged in their own imaginations, every man to be still accompanied with two spirits, whereof they called the one *genius bonus*, the other *genius malus*: the Greeks called them *ευδαιμονα* and *κακοδαιμονα*: whereof the former they said, persuaded him to all the good he did: the other enticed him to all the evil. But praised be God we that are christians, and walks not amongst the *Cimmerian* conjectures of man, knows well enough, that it is the good spirit of God only, who is the fountain of all goodness, that persuades us to the thinking or doing of any good: and that it is our corrupted flesh and Satan, that entices us

to the contrary. And yet the Devil for confirming in the heads of ignorant Christians, that error first maintained among the Gentiles, he whilst among the first kind of spirits that I speak of, appeared in time of *Poperie* and blindness, and haunted divers houses, without doing any evil, but doing as it were necessary turns up and down the house: and this spirit they called *Brownie* in our language, who appeared like a rough-man: yes, some were so blinded, as to believe that their house was all the luckier, as they called it, that such spirits resorted there.

Phi. But since the Devil's intention in all his actions, is ever to do evil, what evil was there in that form of doing, since their actions outwardly were good.

Epi. Was it not evil enough to deceive simply ignorant, in making them to take him for an Angel of light, and so to account of God's enemy, as of their particular friend: where by the contrary, all we that are Christians, ought assuredly to know that since the coming of Christ in the flesh, and establishing of his Church by the Apostles, all miracles, visions, prophecies, and appearances of Angels or good spirits are ceased. Which served only for the first sowing of faith, and planting of the Church. Where now the Church being established, and the white Horse whereof I spoke before, having made his conquest, the Law and Prophets are thought sufficient to serve us, or make us inexcusable, (M28) as Christ says in his parable of *Lazarus* and the rich man.

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

The description of a particular sort of that kind of following spirits, called Incubi and Succubi: And what is the reason wherefore these kinds of spirits haunts most the Northern and barbarous parts of the world.

Philomathes. The next question that I would sphere, is likewise concerning this first of these two kinds of spirits that you have conjoined: and it is this; you know how it is commonly written and reported, that amongst the rest of the sorts of spirits that follows certain persons, there is one more monstrous than all the rest: in respect as it is alleged, they converse naturally with them whom they trouble and haunts with: and therefore I would know in two things your opinion herein: First if such a thing can be: and next if it be: whether there be a difference of sexes amongst these spirits or not.

Epi. That abominable kind of the Devil's abusing of men or women, was called of old, *Incubi* and *Succubi*, according to the difference of the sexes that they conversed with. By two means this great kind of abuse might possibly be performed: The one, when the Devil only as a spirit, and stealing out the sperm of a dead body, abuses them that way, they not readily seeing any shape or feeling any thing, but that which he so conveys in that part: As we read of a Monastery of Nunes which were burnt for their being that way abused. The other mean is when he borrows a dead body and so visibly, and as it seems unto them naturally as a man converses with them. But it is to be noted, that in whatsoever way he uses it, that sperm seems intolerably cold to the person abused. For if he steal out the

nature of a quick person, it cannot be so quickly carried, but it will both tin the strength and heat by the way, which it could never have had for lack of agitation, which in the time of procreation is the procurer and awakener up of these two natural qualities. And if he occupying the dead body as his lodging expel the same out thereof in the dew time, it must likewise be cold by the participation with the qualities of the dead body out of which of it comes. And whereas you inquire if these spirits be divided in sexes or not, I think the rules of Philosophy may easily resolve a man of the contrary: For it is a sure principle of that art, that nothing can be divided in sexes, except such living bodies as must have a natural seed to genere by. But we know spirits has no seed proper to themselves, nor yet can they gender one with an other.

Phi. How is it then that they say sundry monsters have been gotten by that way.

Epi. These tales are nothing but *Aniles fabulae*. For that they have no nature of their own, I have showed you already. And that the cold nature of a dead body, can work nothing in generation, it is more than plain, as being already dead of itself as well as the rest of the body is, wanting the natural heat, and such other natural operation, as is necessary for working that effect, and in case such a thing were possible (which were all utterly against all the rules of nature) it would breed no monster, but only such a natural of-spring, as would have come between that man or woman and that other abused person, in-case they both being alive had had a do with other. For the Devil's part therein, is but the naked carrying or expelling of that substance: And so it could not participate with no quality of the same. Indeed, it is possible to the craft of the Devil to make a woman's belly to swell after he has that way abused her, which he may do, either by stirring up her own humor, or by herbs, as we see beggars daily do. And when the time of her delivery should come to make her suffer great sorrows, like unto that natural course, and then subtly to slip in the Mid-wives hands, stocks, stones, or some monstrous barn brought from some other place, but this is more reported and guessed at by others, than believed by me.

Phi. But what is the cause that this kind of abuse is thought to be most common in such wild parts of the world, as *Lap-land*, and *Fin-land*, or in our North IIs of *Orkney* and *Shetland*.

Epi. Because where the Devil finds greatest ignorance and barbarity, there assails he grossly, as I gave you the reason wherefore there was more Witches of women kind than men.

Phi. Can any be so unhappy as to give their willing consent to the Devil's vile abusing them in this form.

Epi. Yes, some of the Witches have confessed, that he has persuaded them to give their willing consent to it, that he may thereby have them entangled the surer in his snares; But as the other compelled sort is to be pitied and prayed for, so is this most highly to be punished and detested.

Phi. It is not the thing which we cal the *Mare*, which takes folks sleeping in their beds, a kind of these spirits, whereof you are speaking?

Epi. No, that is but a natural sickness, which the Doctors has given that name of *Incubus* unto *ab incubando*, because it being a thick phlegm, falling into our breast upon the hart, while we are sleeping, intercludes so our vital spirits, and takes all power from us, as makes us think that there were some unnatural burden or spirit, lying upon us and holding us down.

CHAPTER III.

ARGUMENT.

The description of the Demoniacs and possessed. By what reason the Papists may have power to cure them.

Philomathes. Well, I have told you now all my doubts, and you have satisfied me therein, concerning the first of these two kinds of spirits that you have conjoined. Now I am to inquire only two things at you concerning the last kind, I mean the Demoniacs. The first is, whereby shall these possessed folks be discerned from them that are troubled with a natural Frenzy or Many. The next is, how can it be that they can be remedied by the Papists Church, whom we counting as Heretics, (M29) it should appear that one Devil should not cast out an other, for then would *his kingdom be divided in it self*, as CHRIST said.

Epi. As to your first question; there are divers symptoms, whereby that heavy trouble may be discerned from a natural sickness, and especially three, omitting the divers vain signs that the *Papists* attributes unto it: Such as the raging at holy water, their fleeing a back from the Croc, their not abiding the hearing of God named, and innumerable such like vain things that were alike troublesome and feckless to recite. But to come to these three symptoms then, whereof I spoke, I account the one of them to be the incredible strength of the possessed creature, which will farr exceed the strength of six of the wight and maddest of any other men that are not so troubled. The next is the emboldening up so far of the patients breast and belly, with such an unnatural stirring and vehement agitation within them: And such an irony hardness of his sinews so stiffly bended out, that it were not possible to prick out as it were the skin of any other person so far: so mightily works the Devil in all the members and senses of his body, he being locally within the same, suppose of his soul and affections thereof, he have no more power then of any other mans. The last is, the speaking of sundry languages, which the patient is known by them that were acquaint with him never to have learned, and that with an uncouth and hollow voice, and all the time of his speaking, a greater motion being in his breast then in his mouth. But from this last symptom is excepted such, as are altogether in the time of their possessing bereft of all their senses being possessed with a dum and blind spirit, whereof Christ relieved one, in the 12. of *Matthew*. And as to your next demand, it is first to be doubted if the *Papists* or any not professing the the only true Religion, can relieve any of that trouble. And next, in-case they can, upon what respects it is possible unto them. As to the former upon two reasons, it is grounded: first that it is known so many of them to be counterfeit, which wil the Clergy invents for confirming of their rotten Religion. The next is, that by

experience we find that few, who are possessed indeed, are fully cured by them: but rather the Devil is content to release the bodily hurting of them, for a short space, thereby to obtain the perpetual hurt of the souls of so many that by these false miracles may be induced or confirmed in the profession of that erroneous Religion: even as I told you before that he does in the false cures, or casting off of diseases by Witches. As to the other part of the argument in-case they can, which rather (with reverence of the learned thinking otherwise) I am induced to believe, by reason of the faithful report that men sound of religion, have made according to their sight thereof, I think if so be, I say these may be the respects, whereupon the *Papists* may have that power. CHRIST gave a commission and power to his Apostles to cast out Devil's, which they according to it put in execution: The rules he bad them observe in that action, was fasting and prayer: and the action it self to be done in his name. This power of theirs proceeded not then of any virtue in them, but only in him who directed them. As was clearly proved by *Judas* his having as great power in that commission, as any of the rest. It is easy then to be understand that the casting out of Devil's, is by the virtue of fasting and prayer, and in-calling of the name of God, suppose many imperfections be in the person that is the instrument,(M30) as CHRIST himself teaches us of the power that false Prophets shall have to caste out Devils. It is no wonder then, these respects of this action being considered, that it may be possible to the *Papists*, though erring in sundry points of Religion to accomplish this, if they use the right form prescribed by CHRIST herein. For what the worse is that action that they err in other things, more then their Baptism is the worse that they err in the other Sacrament, and have eked many vain omens to the Baptism itself.

Phi. Surely it is no little wonder that God should permit the bodies of any of the faithful to be so dishonored, as to be a dwelling place to that unclean spirit.

Epi. There is it which I told right now, would prove and strengthen my argument of the devils' entering in the dead bodies of the faithful. For if he is permitted to enter in their living bodies, even when they are joined with the soul: how much more will God permit him to enter in their dead carrions, which is no more man, but the filthy and corruptible husk of man. For as CHRIST saith, (M31) *It is not any thing that enters within man that defiles him, but only that which proceeds and comes out of him.*

CHAPTER V.

ARGUMENT.

The description of the fourth kind of Spirits called the Fairy: What is possible therein, and what is but illusions. How far this Dialogue entreats of all these things, and to what end.

Philomathes. Now I pray you come on to that fourth kind of spirits.

Epi. That fourth kind of spirits, which by the Gentiles was called *Diana*, and her wandering court, and amongst us was called the *Fairy* (as I told you) or our good neighbours, was one of the sorts of illusions that was rife in the time of *Popery*: for although

it was holden odious to Prophecy by the devil, yet whom these kind of Spirits carried away, and informed, they were thought to be luckiest and of best life. To speak of the many vain chatter founded upon that illusion: How there was a King and Queen of *Fairy*, of such a jolly court and train as they had, how they had a tithe, and duty, as it were, of all goods: how they naturally rode and went, eat and drank, and did all other actions like natural men and women: I think it more like VIRGIL'S *Campi Elysii*, than any thing that ought to be believed by Christians, except in general, that as I spoke sundry times before, the devil eluded the senses of sundry simply creatures, in making them believe that they saw and hard such things as were nothing so indeed.

Phi. But how can it be then, that sundry Witches have gone to death with that confession, that they have ben transported with the *Fairy* to such a hill, which opening, they went in, and there saw a fair Queen, who being now lighter, gave them a stone that had sundry virtues, which at sundry times has been produced in judgment?

Epi. I say that, even as I said before of that imaginary ravishing of the spirit forth of the body. For may not the devil object to their fantasy, their senses being dulled, and as it were a sleep, such hills & houses within them, such glistening courts and trains, and whatsoever such like wherewith he pleases to delude them. And in the mean time their bodies being senseless, to convey in their hand any stone or such like thing, which he makes them to imagine to have received in such a place.

Phi. But what say you to their fore-telling the death of sundry persons, whom they allege to have scene in these places? That is, a true dream (as they say) since they see it walking.

Epi. I think that either they have not been sharply enough examined, that gave so blunt a reason for their Prophecy, or otherwise, I think it likewise as possible that the Devil may prophesy to them when he deceives their imaginations in that sort, as well as when he plainly speaks unto them at other times for their prophesying, is but by a kind of vision, as it were, wherein he commonly counterfeits God among the Pagans, as I told you before.

Phi. I would know now whether these kinds of spirits may only appear to Witches, or if they may also appear to any other.

Epi. They may do to both, to the innocent sort, either to afraid them, or to seem to be a better sort of folks than unclean spirits are, and to the Witches, to be a color of safety for them, that ignorant Magistrates may not punish them for it, as I told even now. But as the one sort, for being perforce troubled with them ought to be pitied, so ought the other sort (who may be discerned by their taking upon them to Prophecy by them,) That sort I say, ought as severely to be punished as any other Witches, and rather the more, that that they go dissemblingly to work.

Phi. And what makes the spirits have so different names from others.

Epi. Even the knavery of that same devil; who as he eludes the *Necromancers* with innumerable feigned names for him and his angels, as in special, making *Satan*, *Beelzebub*, and *Lucifer*, to be three sundry spirits, where we find the two former, but divers names

given to the Prince of all the rebelling angels by the Scripture. As by CHRIST, the Prince of all the Devil's is called, *Beelzebub* in that place, which I alleged against the power of any heretics to cast out Devils. By JOHN in the Revelation, the old tempter is called, *Satan the Prince of all the evil angels*. And the last, to wit, *Lucifer*, is but by allegorical taken from *the day Star* (so named in divers places of the Scriptures) because of his excellency (I mean the Prince of them) in his creation before his fall. Even so I say he deceives the Witches, by attributing to himself divers names: as if every divers shape that he trans forms himself in, were a divers kind of spirit.

Phi. But I have heard many more strange tales of this *Fairy*, than you have yet told me.

Epi. As well I do in that, as I did in all the rest of my discourse. For because the ground of this conference of ours, proceeded of your asking at me at our meeting, if there was such a thing as Witches or spirits: And if they had any power: I therefore have framed my whole discourse, only to prove that such things are and may be, by such number of examples as I show to be possible by reason: and keeps me from dipping any further in playing the part of a Dictionary, to tell what ever I have read or hard in that purpose, which both would exceed faith, and rather would seem to teach such unlawful arts, than to disallow and condemn them, as it is the duty of all Christians to do.

CHAPTER VI.

ARGUMENT.

Of the trial and punishment of Witches. What sort of accusation ought to be admitted against them. What is the cause of the increasing so far of their number in this age.

Philomathes. Then to make an end of our conference, since I see it draws late, what form of punishment think you merits these *Magicians* and Witches? For I see that you account them to be all alike guilty?

Epi. They ought to be put to death according to the Law of God, the civil and imperial law, and municipal law of all Christian nations.

Phi. But what kind of death I pray you?

Epi. It is commonly used by fire, but that is an indifferent thing to be used in every country, according to the Law or custom thereof.

Phi. But ought no sex, age nor rank to be exempted?

Epi. None at all (being so used by the lawful Magistrate) for it is the highest point of Idolatry, wherein no exception is admitted by the law of God.

Phi. Then children may not be spared?

Epi. Yes, not a hair the less of my conclusion. For they are not that capable of reason as to practice such things. And for any being in company and not revealing thereof, their less and ignorant age will no doubt excuse them.

Phi. I see you condemn them all that are of the counsel of such crafts.

Epi. No doubt, for as I said, speaking of *Magic*, the consultants, trusters in, overseers, entertainers or stirrers up of these crafts-folk, are equally guilty with themselves that are the practitioners.

Phi. Whether may the Prince then, or supreme Magistrate, spare or over-see any that are guilty of that craft? upon some great respects known to him?

Epi. The Prince or Magistrate for further trials cause, may continue the punishing of them such a certain space as he thinks convenient: But in the end to spare the life, and not to strike when God bids strike, and so severely punish in so odious a fault and treason against God, it is not only unlawful, but doubtless no less sin in that Magistrate, than it was in SAUL'S sparing of AGAG. And so comparable (M32) to the sin of Witchcraft itself, as SAMUEL alleged at that time.

Phi. Surely then, I think since this crime ought to be so severely punished. Judges ought to beware to condemn any, but such as they are sure are guilty, neither should the clattering report of a hag serve in so weighty a case.

Epi. Judges ought indeed to beware whom they condemn: For it is as great a crime (M33) (as SOLOMON says,) *To condemn the innocent, as to let the guilty escape free*; neither ought the report of any one infamous person, be admitted for a sufficient proof, which can stand of no law.

Phi. And what may a number then of guilty persons confessions, work against one that is accused?

Epi. The assize must serve for interpreter of our law in that respect. But in my opinion, since in a matter of treason against the Prince, barnes or wives, or never so defamed persons, may of our law serve for sufficient witnesses and proofs. I think surely that by a far greater reason, such witnesses may be sufficient in matters of high treason against God: For who but Witches can be proves, and so witnesses of the doings of Witches.

Phi. Indeed, I believe they will be loath to put any honest man upon their counsel. But what if they accuse folk to have been present at their Imaginary conventions in the spirit, when their bodies lies senseless, as you have said.

Epi. I think they are not a hair the less guilty: For the Devil durst never have borrowed their shadow or similitude to that turn, if their consent had not been at it: And the consent in these turns is death of the law.

Phi. Then SAMUEL was a Witch: For the Devil resembled his shape, and played his person in giving response to SAUL.

Epi. SAMUEL was dead as well before that; and so none could slander him with meddling in that unlawful art. For the cause why, as I take it, that God will not permit Satan to use the shapes or similitudes of any innocent persons at such unlawful times, is that God will not permit that any innocent persons shall be slandered with that vile defection: for then the devil would find ways anew, to calumniate the best. And this we have in proof by them that are carried with the *Fairy*, who never see the shadows of any in that court, but of them that thereafter are tried to have been brethren and sisters of that

craft. And this was likewise proved by the confession of a young Lass, troubled with spirits, laid on her by Witchcraft. That although she saw the shapes of diverse men and women troubling her, and naming the persons whom these shadows represents: yet never one of them are found to be innocent, but all clearly tried to be most guilty, and the most part of them confessing the same. And besides that, I think it has ben seldom hard tell of, that any whom persons guilty of that crime accused, as having known them to be their marrows by eye-sight, and not by hear-say, but such as were so accused of Witchcraft, could not be clearly tried upon them, were at the least publicly known to be of a very evil life and reputation: so jealous is God I say, of the fame of them that are innocent in such causes. And besides that; there are two other good helps that may be used for their trial: the one is the finding of their mark, and the trying the insensibility thereof. The other is their fleeting on the water: for as in a secret murder, if the dead carcass be at any time thereafter handled by the murderer, it will gush out of blood, as if the blvd were crying to the heaven for revenge of the murderer, God having appointed that secret super-natural sign, for trial of that secret unnatural crime, so it appears that God has appointed (for a super-natural sign of the monstrous impiety of the Witches) that the water shall refuse to receive them in her bosom, that have shaken off them the sacred Water of Baptism, and willfully refused the benefit thereof: No not so much as their eyes are able to shed tears (threaten and torture them as you please) while first they repent (God not permitting them to dissemble their obstinacy in so horrible a crime) although the women kind especially, be able otherwise to shed tears at every light occasion when they will, yes, although it were dissemblingly like the *Crocodiles*.

Phi. Well, we have made this conference to last as long as leisure would permit: And to conclude then, since I am to take my leave of you, I pray God to purge this Country of these devilish practices: for they were never so rife in these parts, as they are now.

Epi. I pray God that so be to. But the causes are over manifest, that makes them to be so rife. For the great wickedness of the people on the one part, procures this horrible defection, whereby God justly punishes sin, by a greater iniquity. And on the other part, the consummation of the world, and our deliverance drawing near, (M34) makes Satan to rage the more in his instruments, knowing his kingdom to be so near an end. And so fare-well for this time.

F I N I S .

NEWS FROM SCOTLAND.

Declaring the Damnable *life and death of Doctor Fian*, a notable Sorcerer, who was burnt at Edinburgh in January last. 1591.

Which Doctor was register to the Devil that sundry times preached at North Berwick Church, to a number of notorious Witches.

With the true examinations of the said Doctor and Witches, as they uttered them in the presence of *the Scottish King*.

Discovering how they pretended to bewitch and drown his Majesty in the Sea coming from Denmark with such *other wonderful matters as the like has not been heard of at any time*.

Published according to the Scottish Copy.

AT LONDON Printed for William Wright.

TO THE READER.

The Manifold untruths which is spread abroad, concerning the detestable actions and apprehension of those Witches whereof this History following truly entreats, has caused me to publish the same in print: and the rather for that sundry written Copies are lately dispersed thereof, containing, that the said witches were first discovered, by means of a poor Peddler traveling to the town of *Tranent*, and that by a wonderful manner he was in a moment conveyed at midnight, from *Scotland* to *Bordeaux* in *France* (being places of no small distance between) into a Merchants Seller there, and after, being sent from *Bordeaux* into *Scotland* by certain Scottish Merchants to the King's Majesty, that he discovered those Witches and was the cause of their apprehension: with a number of matters miraculous and incredible: All which in truth are most false. Nevertheless to satisfy a number of honest minds, who are desirous to be informed of the verity and truth of their confessions, which for certainty is more stranger then the common report runs, and yet with more truth I have undertaken to publish this short Treatise, which declares the true discourse of all that has happened, and as well what was pretended by those wicked and detestable Witches against the Kings Majesty, as also by what means they wrought the same.

All which examinations (gentle Reader) I have here truly published, as they were taken and uttered in the presence of the King's Majesty, praying you to accept it for verity, the same being so true as cannot be reproved.

DISCOURSE.

A true discourse, of the apprehension of sundry Witches lately taken in Scotland, some are executed, and some are yet imprisoned.

With a particular recital of their examinations, taken in the presence of the King's Majesty.

God by his omnipotent power, has at all times and daily does take such care, and is so vigilant, for the weal and preservation of his own, that thereby he disappoints the wicked practices and evil intents of all such as by any means whatsoever, seek indirectly to conspire any thing contrary to his holy will: yes and by the same power, he has lately overthrown and hindered the intentions and wicked dealings of a great number of ungodly creatures, no better then Devils: who suffering themselves to be allured and enticed by the Devil whom they served, and to whom they were privately sworn: entered into the detestable Art of witchcraft, which they studied and practised so long time, that in the end they had seduced by their sorcery a number of other to be as bad as themselves: dwelling in the bounds of *Lothian*, which is a principal shire or part of *Scotland*, where the

King's Majesty uses to make his chief residence or abode: and to the end that their detestable wickedness which they secretly had pretended against the King's Majesty, the Commonwealth of that Country, with the Nobility and subjects of the same, should come to light: God of his unspeakable goodness did reveal and lay it open in very strange sort, thereby to make known unto the world, that there actions were contrary to the law of God, and the natural affection which we ought generally to bear one to another: the manner of the revealing whereof was as follows.

Within the town of *Tranent* in the Kingdom of *Scotland*, there dwells one *David Seaton*, who being deputy Bailiff in the said Town, had a maid servant called *Geillis Duncan*, who used secretly to be absent and to ly forth of her Masters house every other night: this *Geillis Duncan* took in hand to help all such as were troubled or grieved with any kind of sickness or infirmity: and in short space did perform many matters most miraculous, which things forasmuch as she began to do them upon a sudden, having never don the like before, made her Master and others to be in great amazement, and wondered thereat: by means whereof the said *David Seaton* had his maid in some great suspicion, that she did not those things by natural and lawful ways, but rather supposed it to be done by some extraordinary and unlawful means.

Whereupon, her Master began to grow very inquisitive, and examined her which way and by what means she were able to perform matters of so great importance: whereat she gave him no answer, nevertheless, her Master to the intent that he might the better try and find out the truth of the same, did with the help of others, torment her with the torture of the Thumbscrews upon her fingers, which is a grievous torture, and binding or wrenching her head with a cord or rope, which is a most cruel torment also, yet would she not confess any thing, whereupon they suspecting that she had been marked by the Devil (as commonly witches are) made diligent search about her, and found the enemies mark to be in her fore crag or forepart of her throat: which being found, she confessed that all her doings was done by the wicked enticements and enticements of the Devil, and that she did them by witchcraft.

After this her confession, she was committed to prison, where she continued for a season, where immediately she accused these persons following to be notorious witches, and caused them forthwith to be apprehended one after an other, viz.. *Agnes Samson* the eldest Witch of them all, dwelling in Haddington, *Agnes Tompson* of Edinburgh, Doctor *Fian*, alias *John Cunningham*, master of the School at Salt pans in Lothian, of whose life and strange acts, you shall hear more largely in the end of this discourse: these were by the said *Geillis Duncan* accused, as also *George Motes* wife dwelling in Salt pans, *Robert Grierson* skipper, and *Janet Bandilandis*, with the Porters wife of Seaton, the Smith at the brig Hallis with innumerable others in that parts, and dwelling in those bounds aforesaid: of whom some are already executed, the rest remain in prison, to receive the doom of Judgment at the Kings majesty's will and pleasure.

The said *Geillis Duncan* also caused *Euphame Meealrean* to be apprehended, who conspired and performed the death of her Godfather, and who used her art upon a

gentleman being one of the Lords and Justices of the Session, for bearing good will to her Daughter: she also caused to be apprehended one *Barbara Napier*, for bewitching to death *Archibald*, last Earl of Angus, who languished to death by witchcraft and yet the same was not suspected, but that he died of so strange a disease, as the Physician knew not how to cure or remedy the same: but of all other the said witches, these two last before recited, were reputed for as civil honest women as any that dwelt within the Citi of Edinburgh, before they were apprehended. Many other besides were taken dwelling in Lies, who are detained in prison, until his Majesty's further will and pleasure be known: of whose wicked doings you shall particularly hear, which was as follows.

This aforesaid *Agnes Samson* which was the elder Witch, was taken and brought to Holyrood house before the King's Majesty and sundry other of the nobility of Scotland, where she was straitly examined, but all the persuasions which the King's majesty used to her with the rest of his counsel, might not provoke or induce her to confess any thing, but stood stiffly in the denial of all that was laid to her charge: whereupon they caused her to be conveyed away to prison, there to receive such torture as has been lately provided for witches in that country: and forasmuch as by due examination of witchcraft and witches in Scotland, it has lately been found that the Devil doth generally mark them with a privy mark, by reason the Witches have confessed themselves, that the Devil doth lick them with his tongue in some privy part of their body, before he doth receive them to be his servants, which mark commonly is given them under the hair in some part of their body, whereby it may not easily be found out or scene, although they be searched: and generally so long as the mark is not seen to those which search them, so long the parties that has the mark will never confess any thing. Therefore by special commandment this *Agnes Samson* had all her hair shaven of, in each part of her body, and her head twisted with a rope according to the custom of that Country, being a pain most grievous, which she continued almost an hour, during which time she would not confess any thing until the Devils mark was found upon her secrets, then she immediately confessed whatsoever was demanded of her, and justifying those persons aforesaid to be notorious witches.

Item, the said *Agnes Tompson* was after brought again before the Kings Majesty and his Counsel, and being examined of the meetings and detestable dealings of those witches, she confessed that upon the night of *Allhallow* Even last, she was accompanied as well with the persons aforesaid, as also with a great many other witches, to the number of two hundred: and that all they together went by Sea each one in a Riddle or Civ, and went in the same very substantially with Flagons of wine making merry and drinking by the way in the same Riddles or Citizens, to the Church of North Berwick in Lothian, and that after they had landed, took hands on the land and danced this reel or short dance, singing all with one voice.

Gossip go you before, gossip go you, If you will not go before, gossip let me.

At which time she confessed, that this *Geillis Duncan* did go before them playing this reel or dance upon a small Trump, called a Jews Trump, until they entered into the Church of north Berwick.

These confessions made the King in a wonderful admiration, and sent for the said *Geillis Duncan*, who upon the like Trump did play the said dance before the King's Majesty, who in respect of the strangeness of these matters, took great delight to be present at their examinations.

Item, the said *Agnes Tompson* confessed that the Devil being then at North Berwick Church attending their coming in the habit or likeness of a man, and seeing that they tarried over long, he at their coming enjoined them all to a penance, which was, that they should kiss his Buttocks, in sign of duty to him: which being put over the Pulpit barr, every one did as he had enjoined them: and having made his ungodly exhortations, wherein he did greatly inveigh against the King of Scotland, he received their oaths for their good and true service towards him, and departed: which done, they returned to Sea, and so home again.

At which time the witches demanded of the Devil why he did bear such hatred to the King, who answered, by reason the King is the greatest enemy he has in the world: all which their confessions and depositions are still extant upon record.

Item, the said *Agnes Samson* confessed before the King's Majesty sundry things which were so miraculous and strange, as that his Majesty said they were all extreme liars, at which she answered, she would not wish his Majesty to suppose her words to be false, but rather to believe them, in that she would discover such matter unto him as his majesty should not any way doubt off.

And thereupon taking his Majesty a little aside, she declared unto him the very words which passed between the King's Majesty and his Queen at Oslo in Norway the first night of their marriage, with their answer each to other: whereat the King's Majesty wondered greatly, and swore by the living God, that he believed that all the Devils in hell could not have discovered the same: acknowledging her words to be most true, and therefore gave the more credit to the rest which is before declared.

Touching this *Agnes Tompson*, she is the only woman, who by the Devils persuasion should have intended and put in execution the Kings Majesty's death in this manner.

She confessed that she took a black Toad, and did hang the same up by the heels, three days, and collected and gathered the venom as it dropped and fell from it in an Oyster shell, and kept the same venom close covered, until she should obtain any part or piece of foul linen cloth, that had pertained to the King's Majesty, as shirt, handkerchief, napkin or any other thing which she practised to obtain by means of one *John Kers*, who being attendant in his Majesty's Chamber, desired him for old acquaintance between them, to help her to one or a piece of such a cloth as is aforesaid, which thing the said *John Kers* denied to help her too, saying he could not help her too it.

And the said *Agnes Tompson* by her depositions since her apprehension says, that if she had obtained any one piece of linen cloth which the King had worn and fouled, she had bewitched him to death, and put him to such extraordinary pains, as if he had been lying upon sharp thorns and ends of Needles.

Moreover she confessed that at the time when his Majesty was in Denmark, she being accompanied with the parties before specially named, took a Cat and christened it, and afterward bound to each part of that Cat, the chief parts of a dead man, and several joints of his body, and that in the night following the said Cat was conveyed into the midst of the sea by all these witches sailing in their riddles or Citizens as is aforesaid, and so left the said Cat right before the Town of Lies in Scotland: this done, there did arise such a tempest in the Sea, as a greater has not been seen: which tempest was the cause of the perishing of a Boat or vessel coming over from the town of Brunt Island to the town of Lies, wherein was sundry Jewels and rich gifts, which should have been presented to the now Queen of Scotland, at her Majesty's coming to Lies.

Again it is confessed, that the said christened Cat was the cause that the Kings Majesty's Ship at his coming forth of Denmark, had a contrary wind to the rest of his Ships, then being in his company, which thing was most strange and true, as the King's Majesty acknowledges, for when the rest of the Ships had a fair and good wind, then was the wind contrary and altogether against his Majesty: and further the said witch declared, that his Majesty had never come safely from the Sea, if his faith had not prevailed above their intentions.

Moreover the said Witches being demanded how the Devil would use them when he was in their company, they confessed that when the Devil did receive them for his servants, and that they had vowed themselves unto him, then he would Carnally use them, although to their little pleasure, in respect of his cold nature: and would doo the like at sundry other times.

As touching the aforesaid Doctor *Fian*, alias *John Cunningham*, the examination of his acts since his apprehension, declares the great subtlety of the devil, and therefore makes things to appear the more miraculous: for being apprehended by the accusation of the said *Geillis Duncan* aforesaid, who confessed he was their Register, and that there was not one man suffered to come to the Devils readings but only he: the said Doctor was taken and imprisoned, and used with the accustomed pain, provided for those offences, inflicted upon the rest as is aforesaid.

First by twisting of his head with a rope, at which he would confess nothing.

Secondly, he was persuaded by fair means to confess his follies, but that would prevail as little.

Lastly he was put to the most severe and cruel pain in the world, called the boots, who after he had received three strokes, being inquired if he would confess his damnable acts and wicked life, his tongue would not serve him to speak, in respect whereof the rest of the witches willed to search his tongue, under which was found two pins thrust up into the head, whereupon the witches did lay, *Now is the Charm stinted*, and showed that those charmed Pins were the cause he could not confess any thing: then was he immediately released of the boots, brought before the King, his confession was taken, and his own hand willingly set ther-unto, which contained as follows.

First, that at the general meetings of those witches, he was always present: that he was Clarke to all those that were in subjection to the Devils service, bearing the name of witches, that always he did take their oaths for their true service to the Devil, and that he wrote for them such matters as the Devil still pleased to command him.

Item, he confessed that by his witchcraft he did bewitch a Gentleman dwelling near to the Salt pans, where the said Doctor kept School, only for being enamored of a Gentlewoman whom he loved himself: by means of which his Sorcery, witchcraft and devilish practices, he caused the said Gentleman that once in 24. hours he fell into a lunacy and madness, and so continued one whole hour together, and for the verity of the same, he caused the Gentleman to be brought before the King's Majesty, which was upon the 24. day of December last, and being in his Majesty's Chamber, suddenly he gave a great screech and fell into a madness, sometime bending himself, and sometime capering so directly up, that his head did touch the ceiling of the Chamber, to the great admiration of his Majesty and others then present: so that all the Gentlemen in the Chamber were not able to hold him, until they called in more help, who together bound him hand and foot: and suffering the said gentleman to ly still until his fury were past, he within an hour came again to himself, when being demanded of the King's Majesty what he saw or did all that while, answered that he had been in a sound sleep.

Item the said Doctor did also confess that he had used means sundry times to obtain his purpose and wicked intent of the same Gentlewoman, and seeing himself disappointed of his intention, he determined by all ways he might to obtain the same, trusting by conjuring, witchcraft and Sorcery to obtain it in this manner.

It happened this gentlewoman being unmarried, had a brother who went to school with the said Doctor, and calling his Scholar to him, demanded if he did ly with his sister, who answered he did, by means whereof he thought to obtain his purpose, and therefore secretly promised to teach him without stripes, so he would obtain for him three hairs of his sisters secrets, at such time as he should spy best occasion for it: which the youth promised faithfully to perform, and vowed speedily to put it in practice, taking a piece of conjured paper of his master to lap them in when he had gotten them: and thereupon the boy practised nightly to obtain his masters purpose, especially when his sister was a sleep.

But God who knows the secrets of all hearts, and reveals all wicked and ungodly practices, would not suffer the intents of this devilish Doctor to come to that purpose which he supposed it would, and therefore to declare that he was heavily offended with his wicked intent, did so work by the Gentlewoman's own means, that in the end the same was discovered and brought to light: for she being one night a sleep, and her brother in bed with her, suddenly cried out to her mother, declaring that her Brother would not suffer her to sleep, whereupon her mother having a quick capacity, did vehemently suspect Doctor *Fian's* intention, by reason she was a witch of herself, and therefore presently arose, and was very inquisitive of the boy to understand his intent, and the better to know the same, did beat him with sundry stripes, whereby he discovered the truth unto her.

The Mother therefore being well practised in witchcraft, did think it most convenient to meet with the Doctor in his own Art, and thereupon took the paper from the boy, wherein he should have put the same hairs, and went to a young Heifer which never had borne Calf nor gone to the Bull, and with a pair of shears, clipped off three hairs from the udder of the Cow, and wrapt them in the same paper, which she again delivered to the boy, then willing him to give the same to his said Master, which he immediately did.

The Schoolmaster so soon as he had received them, thinking them indeed to be the Maids hairs, went straight and wrought his art upon them: But the Doctor had no sooner done his intent to them, but presently the Heifer or Cow whose hairs they were indeed, came unto the door of the Church wherein the Schoolmaster was, into the which the Heifer went, and made towards the Schoolmaster, leaping and dancing upon him, and following him forth of the church and to what place so ever he went, to the great admiration of all the towns men of Salt pans, and many other who did behold the same.

The report whereof made all men imagine that he did work it by the Devil, without whom it could never have been so sufficiently effected: and thereupon, the name of the said Doctor *Fian* (who was but a very yong man) began to grow so common among the people of Scotland, that he was secretly nominated for a notable Conjurer.

All which although in the beginning he denied, and would not confess, yet having felt the pain of the boots (and the charm stinted, as aforesaid) he confessed all the aforesaid to be most true, without producing any witnesses to justify the same, and thereupon before the kings majesty he subscribed the said confessions with his own hand, which for truth remains upon record in *Scotland*.

After that the depositions and examinations of the said doctor *Fian Alias Cunningham* was taken, as already is declared, with his own hand willingly set to it, he was by the master of the prison committed to ward, and appointed to a chamber by himself, where forsaking his wicked ways, acknowledging his most ungodly life, showing that he had too much followed the enticements and enticements of Satan, and fondly practised his conclusions by conjuring, witchcraft, enchantment, sorcery, and such like, he renounced the devil and all his wicked works, vowed to lead the life of a Christian, and seemed newly connected towards God.

The morrow after upon conference had with him, he granted that the devil had appeared unto him in the night before, dressed all in black, with a white wand in his hand, and that the devil demanded of him if he would continue his faithful service, according to his first oath and promise made to that effect. Whom (as he then said) he utterly renounced to his face, and said unto him in this manner, *Avoid Satan, avoid*, for I have listened too much unto you, and by the same you have undone me, in respect whereof I utterly forsake you. To whom the devil answered, *That once before you die you shall be mine*. And with that (as he said) the devil brake the white wand, and immediately vanished forth of his sight.

Thus all the dai this Doctor *Fian* continued very solitary, and seemed to have care of his own soul, and would call upon God, showing himself penitent for his wicked life, nevertheless the same night he found such means, that he stole the key of the prison door

and chamber in the which he was, which in the night he opened and fled away to the Salt pans, where he was always resident, and first apprehended. Of whose sudden departure when the King's majesty had intelligence, he presently commanded diligent inquiry to be made for his apprehension, and for the better effecting thereof, he sent public proclamations into all parts of his land to the same effect. By means of whose hot and hard pursuit, he was again taken and brought to prison, and then being called before the kings highness, he was reexamined as well touching his departure, as also touching all that had before happened.

But this Doctor, notwithstanding that his own confession appears remaining in record under his own hand writing, and the same to it fixed in the presence of the King's majesty and sundry of his Counsel, yet did he utterly deny the same.

Whereupon the king's majesty perceiving his stubborn willfulness, concerned and imagined that in the time of his absence he had entered into new conference and league with the devil his master, and that he had been again newly marked, for the which he was narrowly searched, but it could not in any wise be found, yet for more trial of him to make him confess, he was commanded to have a most strange torment which was done in this manner following.

His nails upon all his fingers were riven and pulled off with an instrument called in Scottish a *Pincers*, which in England we call a payer of pincers, and under every nail there was thrust in two needles over even up to the heads. At all which torments notwithstanding the Doctor never shrank any whit, neither would he then confess it the sooner for all the tortures inflicted upon him.

Then was he with all convenient speed, by commandment, conveyed again to the torment of the boots, wherein he continued a long time, and did abide so many blows in them, that his legs were crushed and beaten together as small as might be, and the bones and flesh so bruised, that the blood and marrow spouted forth in great abundance, whereby they were made unserviceable for ever. And notwithstanding all these grievous pains and cruel torments he would not confess any thing, so deeply had the devil entered into his heart, that he utterly denied all that which he had before affirmed, and would say nothing to it but this, that what he had done and said before, was only done and said for fear of pains which he had endured.

Upon great consideration therefore taken by the King's majesty and his Counsel, as well for the due execution of justice upon such detestable malefactors, as also for example sake, to remain a terror to all others hereafter, that shall attempt to deal in the like wicked and ungodly actions, as witchcraft, sorcery, conjuration, and such like, the said Doctor *Fian* was soon after arraigned, condemned, and adjudged by the law to die, and then to be burnt according to the law of that land, provided in that behalf. Whereupon he was put into a cart, and being first strangled, he was immediately put into a great fire, being ready provided for that purpose, and there burnt in the Castle hill of *Edinburgh* on a saturday in the end of January last past. 1591. The rest of the witches which are not yet executed, remain in prison till farther trial, and knowledge of his majesty's pleasure.

This strange discourse before recited, may perhaps give some occasion of doubt to such as shall happen to read the same, and thereby conjecture that the King's majesty would not hazard himself in the presence of such notorious witches, least thereby might have ensued great danger to his person and the general state of the land, which thing in truth might well have been feared. But to answer generally to such, let this suffice: that first it is well known that the King is the child and servant of God, and they but servants to the devil, he is the Lords anointed, and they but vessels of God's wrath: he is a true Christian, and trusts in God, they worse than Infidels, for they only trust in the devil, who daily serve them, till he have brought them to utter destruction. But hereby it seems that his Highness carted a magnanimous and undaunted mind, not feared with their enchantments, but resolute in this, that so long as God is with him, he fears not who is against him. And truly the whole scope of this treatise doth so plainly lai open the wonderful providence of the Almighty, that if he had not been defended by his omnipotence and power, his Highness had never returned alive in his voyage frō Denmark, so that there is no dolt but God would as well defend him on the land as on the sea, where they pretended their damnable practice.

FINIS.